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ISSUE 89

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SAGA *On Target Africa* Exclusive CASE STUDY: When *'Within Reach'* Is Not Enough!

OCT 2026

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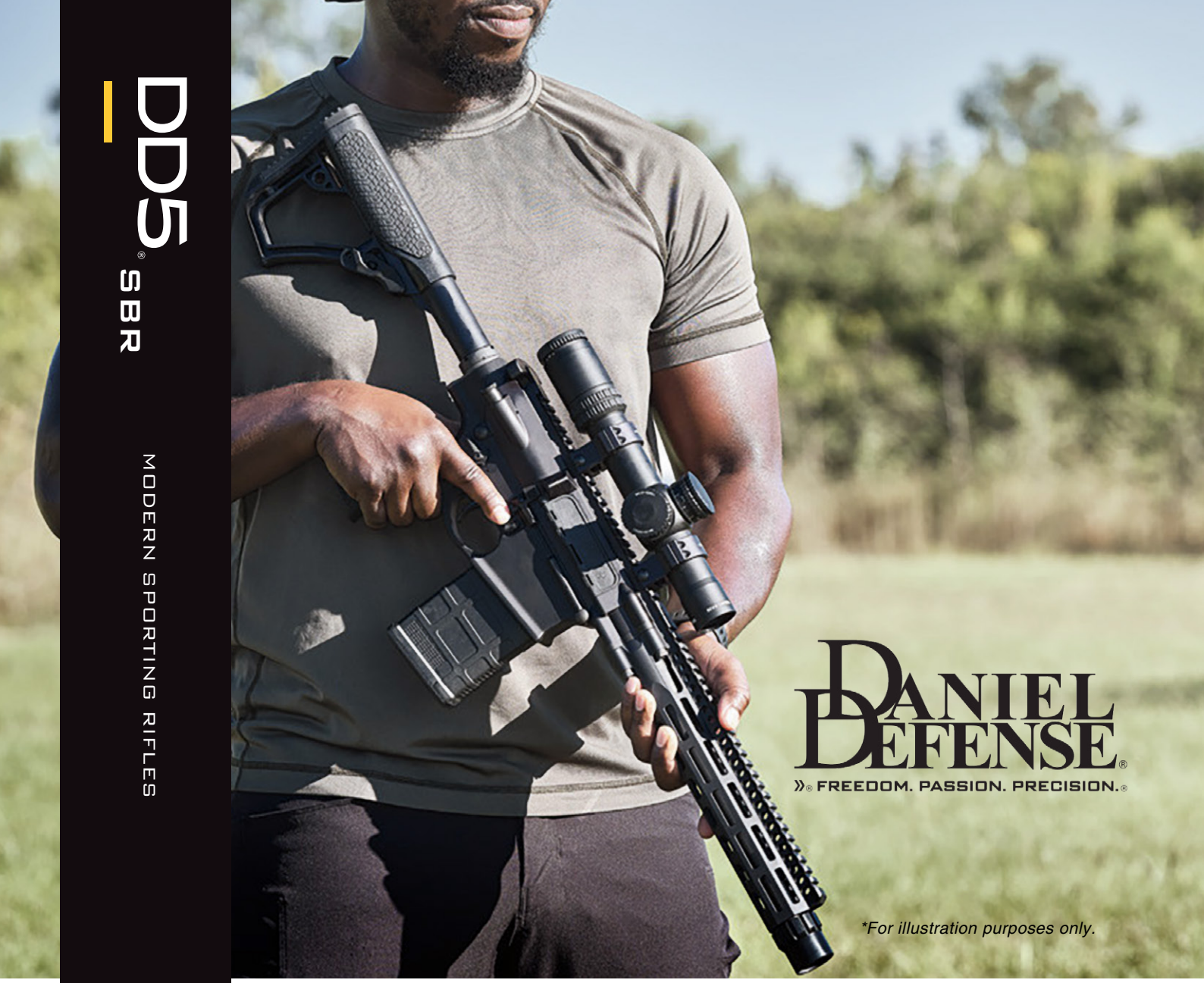

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[1975] – [2026]
With gratitude for his dedication and contribution to *On Target Africa*.

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Feature

4 SA Gunowners' Association (SAGA) delves deeply into 'When 'Within Reach' Is Not Enough!' We include two easy-to-access checklists: 'Firearm owner travel checklist - *A practical pre-trip and overnight checklist'. It supplements – and does not replace – the Firearms Control Act, Regulations or case-specific legal advice.* The second is an 'Event organiser/accommodation provider checklist - *A planning and accountability checklist for clubs, associations, Match Directors, venue owners and accommodation providers'. Legal liability remains fact specific.*

64 John Rigby & Co. has completed its relocation, establishing a new London headquarters designed to bring visitors closer to the craft and history behind its guns. Exclusively distributed through the Safari Outdoor network of stores in South Africa.

Sports-Shooting

12 The South African National Protea F-Open team competed at the F Class World Championship 2026, hosted at the Stickledown range, Bisely, UK from 10 to 16 August. Team Captain Jan Swanepoel shares the three years of preparation and two weeks on the range to win gold as a team in F-Open.
The Farquharson Cup represents the highest level of skill and ability in international long-range precision shooting.

22 The 72nd annual Western Province Open Bisley Championship was held at the home of the Western Province Bisley Association (WPBA), the Good Hope Shooting Range near Melkbosstrand on the Cape West Coast from 1 to 3 October.

30 Clive Mey, SA National Team Manager, reflects on the SA National IPRF Protea team that achieved four podium wins at the IPRF Centrefire World Championship.

34 Metal Mayhem 2026 offered competitors a choice of 14 divisions. The now annual event attracted people from all around to shoot in every division in practical shooting. Long guns, short guns, optics, and iron sight were all well represented. Founders Billy Rosslee and Anco Pretorius thank all sponsors who generously support this annual event. All future sponsorships are welcomed. Make contact now with Billy and Anco to get involved in 2027.

40 Adrian Luppnow from PERPC discusses a major project last year to relocate all handgun ranges from the valley below to next to the existing rifle range to host the Eastern Province Practical Shooting Association (EPPSA) Handgun Level III selection match at the Port Elizabeth Rifle and Pistol Club (PERPC) from 8 to 11 October. This was the first of three handgun selection matches to determine teams to represent South Africa at the IPSC African Handgun Championship (Level IV) to take place in Bulawayo, Zimbabwe in September 2027. It was also the 2026 South African Championship match.

46 Cowboy Action Shooting: Jason 'Roach' Codd shares his account of the national competition, 'The Good, the Bad and the Ugly', held at Lion Mountain Creek range in Bloemfontein from 24 to 26 September. He gives readers insight into the people, atmosphere and action that make this discipline so distinctive.

52 The National Championship remains the undisputed highlight on the South African National School Shooter Union (SANSSU) calendar. The 2026 event from 26 September to 1 October transformed Bloemfontein in the Free State into a buzzing hive of activity with 434 dedicated shooters, officials and supportive parents from across the country.

60 A photographic spread of the Cape Town Hunting Rifle Associations (CTHRSA) Veldskiet Clinic and Mini Competition Heritage Day event.

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from the editor's desk

Success on the international stage has kept South Africa's Protea sports-shooting teams in the spotlight over recent months. Their performances have brought recognition to the country, their teams and their affiliated shooting associations, and the momentum shows no sign of slowing.

The 7th F-Class World Championship, held in Bisley in the UK from 10 to 16 August, presented a formidable challenge for the Protea national team competing in F-Open. Team Captain Jan Swanepoel shares an engaging account of the team's preparation, performance and route to gold. The achievement was a collective one, built on teamwork as much as individual skill.

Less than six weeks after their return, several members of the gold-medal-winning F-Open team were competing at the 72nd annual Western Province Open Bisley Championship at Good Hope Rifle Range. It was a pleasure to see these accomplished shooters in action and to spend a little time with them. These engagements offered a glimpse of the team spirit that Swanepoel helped foster. This was not simply a collection of individual achievements, but a team working together towards a shared goal.

I would also like to thank the Western Province Bisley Association for its kind acknowledgement of our coverage of the 2026 championship. Chairman Rick Jaffe's message recognised the value of media attendance and support in helping events succeed and promoting the sport. From the firing line, spectators see the competition itself; behind the scenes, a great deal of work goes into keeping a match running smoothly, particularly when conditions and unexpected interruptions test the organisers. That effort deserves recognition, too.

With final matches still to come in November, the championship season is not quite over.

The South African Precision Rifle Federation (SAPRF) team returned from the IPRF competition in Texas in the USA at the end of September with an impressive third-place country ranking out of 25 nations. South Africa secured podium finishes in several divisions: the Ladies placed third overall, the Juniors second, the Seniors second and Limited second, with JC Robertson also taking second place overall in Limited. The Open division finished fifth and Factory fourth. Thank you to Team Manager Clive Mey for the report, and congratulations to every competitor and support-team member. The local precision-rifle community followed the team's progress day by day on Impact Scoring, sharing in the highs and lows. Team Captain Warren Britnell summed up the team's spirit in a social media post: "*Julle was bang vir niks*".

Back home, Metal Mayhem demonstrates how a competition can develop a strong identity of its own. Founders, Billy Rosslee and Anco Pretorius of Magnum United Shooting Range, the event is described as South Africa's largest steel-target-only competition. With 250 shooters, two days of competition, an all-steel-target format and prizes valued at over R250 000, it made quite an impression. Competitor Adrian Burrows takes us through the two-day event.

The South African National School Shooter Union (SANSSU) National Championship remains a highlight of the school sports-shooting calendar. Held in Bloemfontein from 26 September to 1 October, the 2026 event brought together 434 shooters, officials and supportive parents from across the country. We thank Helber Rifle Bullets and Innovations for sponsoring the eight-page report in this issue.

The Eastern Province Practical Shooting Association (EPPSA) hosted its Handgun Level III selection match at the Port Elizabeth Rifle and Pistol Club (PERPC) from 8 to 11 October. Adrian Luppnow of PERPC, a valued *On Target Africa* contributor since 2018, reports on the competition.

Cowboy Action Shooting brings a different flavour to this issue. Jason 'Roach' Codd shares his account of the national competition, 'The Good, the Bad and the Ugly', held at Lion Mountain Creek range in Bloemfontein from 24 to 26 September. His report offers readers a look at the people, atmosphere and action that make this discipline so distinctive.

The South African Gunowners' Association (SAGA) shares an exclusive feature addressing the important practical question of when you sleep away from home, is your firearm merely nearby, or is it genuinely under your direct personal and physical control? The feature has been laid out so that readers can copy the pages and keep the information somewhere accessible, such as near a reloading bench or in a safe area.

Our Shooters' Gear pages continue to showcase products that are current and relevant to the South African market, including items on their way to local retailers and online stores. The pages also offer the firearms and accessories industry an opportunity to submit products for consideration at a nominal cost.

As always, we welcome your feedback. Your input helps us shape the direction and relevance of future editions of *On Target Africa*. Please get in touch at **editor@ontargetafrica.co.za.**

As always, we welcome your feedback. Your input remains invaluable in shaping the direction and relevance of future editions of *On Target Africa*.

Please feel free to contact us at **editor@ontargetafrica.co.za**.

Warm regards

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CASE STUDY

When 'Within Reach' Is Not Enough!

Travelling with firearms, nights away from home, the meaning of 'direct control' and the potential negative consequences.

By Shaun Lyle (Trustee, SAGA) and Damian Enslin (Chair, SAGA)
Assisted by Maria Ortelee (Associate, Matthews Enslin Inc.)

Responsible firearm owners know the routine at home. They know where their firearm is, who can reach it, the status of their safe and what security layers protect the property.

Then they travel. A shoot, a hunt, a training weekend or simply a night away can remove much of that familiar security environment.

A Live Case Study

A recent incident involving experienced firearm owners provides a sobering case study: several licensed dedicated sport shooters were staying in private rural accommodation near an event. During the night, intruders entered the sleeping area and moved through it for a prolonged period without waking the occupants. Rooms were searched and personal property was stolen. A licensed handgun, kept immediately beside a sleeping owner, was also taken.

> ***Editorial Note:***
> *The incident has been deliberately anonymised and generalised. Names, exact location, event and other identifying details have been omitted. Legal references and official SAPS forms were checked against publicly available sources as at 5 October 2026.*

The all-important question worth asking is simple: ***When you sleep away from home, is a firearm merely close to you, or is it genuinely under your direct personal and physical control?***

The Legal Test Is Control, Not Proximity

Section 120(8) of the Firearms Control Act deals with safeguarding. In broad terms, a firearm must be locked in prescribed storage when it is not carried on the person **or** under the owner's direct control. It also creates liability where loss or dispossession results from a failure to lock the firearm away or to take reasonable steps against loss or theft while it is on the person or under direct control.

Regulation 86(1) uses the expression "*direct personal and physical control*". If that control is absent, prescribed safe or strongroom storage is required. The Act therefore does not reduce the enquiry to a single question such as "***was it attached to your body?"*** Equally, physical closeness (proximity) alone does not automatically establish direct control.

Reported cases illustrate the risk, but do not create a simple rule for bedside firearms:

- In *Venter v S* the High Court treated "*direct control*" as control exercised directly by the authorised person, rather than through somebody else.
- In *Mongae v Chairperson, Firearms Appeal Board SAPS,* a handgun disappeared from beneath a pillow while its owner went to the bathroom; the later High Court review was dismissed on procedural grounds without deciding whether the safekeeping arrangements complied with the Act.

There is no special *"under-the-pillow"* exception in the Act. If an owner is asleep, the practical questions become obvious: who else can enter the room, is the room secured, can another person reach the firearm and what reasonable measures exist to prevent it being taken?

Ultimately, if you are going to sleep, the prudent course is to place the firearm in a prescribed compliant safe rather than relying on the fact that it is beside you, under a pillow or otherwise within reach. If something goes wrong, the question will **not only be** where the firearm was, but whether you had taken proper steps to prevent another person from gaining access to it.

The consequences of getting this wrong can extend well beyond the loss of the firearm itself. A theft or loss may lead to a criminal investigation and a separate fitness inquiry, even where the owner was also the victim of a crime. The sensible approach is therefore to adopt storage practices that are easy to justify afterwards: use the prescribed safe whenever there is any real doubt about whether the firearm remains under your direct control, and do not wait for an incident to expose a weakness in your arrangements.

What has worked without incident for years does not, by itself, establish compliance.

Section 22 Is Not A Storage Solution

When licensed firearm owners travel together, another trap is assuming that one shooter can simply put everyone's firearms in his or her safe.

Section 22 deals with use of another person's firearm under the licensed owner's immediate supervision, where the use is lawful and safe. It is not a general overnight-storage provision.

Regulation 86(4), reflected in SAPS 539 provides a separate mechanism for a licensed person to store another person's firearm. The permission must be in writing, endorsed by the relevant DFO, and must identify the firearm, the parties, the authorised place of storage, the period and reason for the storage. The firearm must be kept in the prescribed safe at the authorised place. Importantly, the storage arrangement ***does not*** give the custodian a right to use the firearm. Transport to and from the approved place of storage is also regulated and may only take place in accordance with the authorisation contemplated by Regulation 86(4).

A compliant lock-away device may also form part of a firearm owner's travel planning. Regulation 86(12) expressly contemplates a qualifying device that can be securely affixed to another structure, including the body of a vehicle. However, the device itself, its installation and the circumstances in which it is used must comply with the applicable storage requirements. A lockable box bolted into a vehicle should therefore not automatically be assumed to constitute compliant firearm storage.

In short: ***"Please keep my firearm in your safe tonight"*** should not be improvised after arrival. Where third-party storage may be needed, arrange it lawfully before the trip.

CCTV Records. Security Delays, Deters And Warns.

The incident also illustrates a distinction between surveillance and security. CCTV can be invaluable after an intrusion, but it does not necessarily prevent entry.

Doors, locks, alarms, external beams, window security, controlled access and compliant firearm storage are different layers. None guarantees safety, and the absence of any particular layer does not by itself decide legal negligence. But firearm owners travelling with valuable firearms and equipment should assess accommodation more critically than ordinary travellers.

This Is Not Just A Rural Problem

The word *'rural'* can distract from the real risk. A farm stay, hunting lodge, guesthouse, range accommodation or established competition venue can all be insecure. An incident-free history is not, by itself, a security plan.

Events can concentrate valuable firearms and optics in one place. Organisers and accommodation providers should assess access control, alarms, perimeter and room security, and available lawful storage against that foreseeable risk. A precision rifle and optic can represent hundreds of thousands of rand.

Responsibility is fact-specific, but accountability should be clear. The licence holder retains the personal statutory duty to safeguard the firearm. The accommodation provider controls the physical environment and any storage it offers. Where an organiser, club or association selects or recommends accommodation, it should establish and communicate the basic security, storage and emergency arrangements, without assuming or implying custody it has not actually undertaken.

Match Directors, Range Officers and other event officials have a different operational role in terms of range safety, emergency procedures and accurate briefing information. Match information should identify the accommodation contact, nearest SAPS station, nearest medical facility, First Aid arrangements and what firearm-storage options are actually available. A dealer or sponsor supporting an event is not, merely by doing so, the custodian of competitors' firearms.

> ***Note:*** *Practical questions are consolidated into two usable checklists, Annexure A for the travelling firearm owner and Annexure B for organisers and accommodation providers.*

Insurance Is Part Of The Planning

High-value shooting equipment can be worth far more than the firearm alone. Before travelling, confirm off-premises cover for the firearm, optic, accessories and, where applicable, ammunition; whether items must be specified; insured values and excesses; theft from temporary accommodation or a vehicle; and any storage or security conditions.

The same applies to an everyday-carry handgun and its accessories. Do not assume ordinary household or all-risk cover automatically follows the firearm.

A first-class shooting venue does not automatically mean first-class overnight security!

If a Firearm Is Stolen: Report Promptly - Preserve The Facts.

Section 120(11) requires the loss or theft to be reported to the police station nearest the place where it occurred within 24 hours after the person becomes aware of it. ***SAPS 521(f)*** is the official notification form for lost, stolen or found firearms. When making the report, complete the prescribed form fully, accurately, and factually.

Importantly, beyond the information required for that notification, do not volunteer, make or sign any additional statement before obtaining legal advice. You may not appreciate when routine questions about how the theft occurred have shifted into an investigation of your own conduct and possible negligent safekeeping.

In particular, do not allow yourself to be pressured into agreeing that you were negligent, explaining why you believe you complied with the law, or signing a separate written statement merely because an official asks you to do so. A request for an additional statement is not, without more, the same as a legal compulsion to provide one. If the SAPS wishes to question you about possible criminal liability, ask in what capacity you are being questioned and obtain legal advice before responding substantively.

This caution is important because a statement made immediately after a traumatic theft may later be relied upon in a criminal investigation or a section 102 inquiry. Something said casually, inaccurately or without appreciating the legal significance of concepts such as *"direct control" or "safekeeping"* can become central to a later allegation of negligence. Complete the prescribed notification truthfully but take legal advice before providing anything further.

Do not leave with only a verbal assurance that the matter has been "*put in the system*." Retain the CAS/case reference and, where possible, a copy or acknowledgement of the firearm notification.

Preserve the basic record:

- firearm make, model, calibre and serial number;
- licence particulars;
- CAS/case reference and ***SAPS 521(f)***;
- photographs and CCTV footage;
- witness details; and
- any evidence relevant to entry, security and where the firearm was immediately before the theft.

If your phone is stolen too, use another device for the necessary calls and, when lawful, photograph the scene without disturbing evidence. Preserve original files, date/time/location metadata and original CCTV exports where possible. Do not delay the SAPS report while collecting material.

Most importantly, keep the account factual. A police official may form a view about "***direct control"*** in that legal characterisation should not cause the underlying facts to be rewritten. If a statement is materially inaccurate or incomplete, obtain proper advice and correct or supplement it transparently. If the SAPS requests anything beyond the prescribed notification, consult an attorney before making or signing any further statement.

Do not guess. Do not embellish and do not manufacture a better version after the event.

Theft Does Not Automatically Mean Unfitness

A firearm theft can lead to an investigation into safekeeping. ***Section 102*** allows the Registrar to consider unfitness where a person is alleged to have failed to take the prescribed steps for safekeeping.

But a theft is not, by itself, an automatic declaration of unfitness. ***Section 102*** provides a process: written notice, a reasonable opportunity to advance reasons, consideration of the evidence and a right to legal representation at the inquiry. An adverse administrative decision is subject to the statutory appeal process.

The distinction matters. In ***Venter v S,*** the safekeeping conviction was upheld, yet the High Court nevertheless set aside the finding of unfitness and declared the appellant fit to possess a firearm.

If a theft begins developing into an allegation of negligent safekeeping or a Section 102 inquiry, obtain competent firearm-law advice early.

Does the Stolen Firearm "*Come Off Your Name*"?

No. The more precise answer is in ***Regulation 99***. Once the theft or loss has been reported as required by ***Section 120(11)***, the licence, permit or authorisation applicable to that specific firearm is deferred indefinitely. It is not simply erased from the Central Firearms Register.

If the firearm is later recovered and returned, the deferment can lapse and the licence can again operate for its remaining validity, subject to the Act's licence limits. ***Regulation 99*** expressly anticipates that recovery may create an excess-licence situation and provides a mechanism for dealing with it.

Keep proof of the original theft report and confirm that the firearm is correctly recorded as stolen and the licence appropriately deferred.

A Replacement EDC?

A previous theft is not, by itself, a statutory prohibition on applying for another firearm. That assumes, of course, that the applicant remains legally fit to possess a firearm and is not otherwise disqualified under the FCA.

SAPS 271 specifically asks applicants whether firearms have previously been lost or stolen, whether a negligence case was opened, the circumstances and the outcome.

Full disclosure is therefore essential.

For a replacement self-defence handgun, the normal licensing requirements still apply. ***Section 13*** also provides that a person may not hold more than one licence under that section, so the stolen/deferred firearm and any replacement application must be correctly reflected administratively.

You may begin the replacement process, including acquiring a firearm through a dealer for licensing purposes, but you may not take possession of and carry the replacement merely because the previous firearm was stolen. Lawful possession requires the appropriate licence, permit or authorisation.

Section 21 provides for temporary authorisations, but it is discretionary and fact-specific, not an automatic emergency replacement licence or a shortcut around the ordinary process. Where urgent possession is genuinely at issue, obtain current DFO/CFR guidance and, if necessary, case-specific legal advice before relying on that route.

The Real Lesson

This is not about blaming the victim of a carefully executed burglary. The criminals remain responsible for the crime. It is about recognising that lawful firearm ownership carries a second layer of responsibility in anticipating what happens when the security environment you control disappears.

The same lesson scales up. Major national and international matches should use a documented security and emergency plan covering firearm transport and lawful storage, accommodation security, temporary import or authorisation requirements, competent range and safety officials, SAPS and medical contacts, emergency communications and incident response. The larger the event and the number of visiting teams, the less acceptable ad hoc arrangements become.

Before the next hunt, competition, course or road trip, do not only ask: ***Where am I sleeping?*** Ask: ***Where will I keep my firearm while I am asleep, who can get to it, and what is the plan if something goes wrong?*** Because "*it was right next to me*" may be a poor time to discover that within reach and under direct control are not necessarily the same thing.

Plan - Secure - Document and Stay in Control.

Disclaimer:
This article is a general educational discussion of firearm safeguarding and administration. It is not legal advice and does not express a view on the culpability, fitness or legal position of any person involved in the anonymised incident. Individual facts matter. Anyone facing a criminal investigation, a disputed safekeeping allegation or proceedings under sections 102 or 103 should obtain case-specific advice from a suitably qualified legal practitioner.

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Sources & Acknowledgements

- Legal references: Firearms Control Act 60 of 2000, particularly s 13(3), 21, 22, 28, 102, 120(8), 120(11) and 133; Firearms Control Regulations, 2004, particularly regs 86, 91 and 99;
- Official SAPS Forms 271, 518, 521(f) and 539.
- Case-law reference: Venter v S (A505/2016) [2017] ZAGPPHC 384 (21 July 2017), particularly paras 7-12. Mongae v Chairperson, Firearms Appeal Board SAPS (49025/2021) [2023] ZAGPPHC 240 (4 April 2023) is noted only as a factual/procedural illustration; the review was dismissed without the Court determining the safekeeping merits.
- SAGA source material: Factsheet 108 - Temporary Firearm Usage versus Storage; Factsheet 114b - Legally Using Another Person's Licensed Firearm (s22); Factsheet 202 - Travelling with Firearms & Ammunition.
- SAGA also acknowledges the earlier practical guidance of Adv John Welch, former SAGA Chair, on transporting and safeguarding sporting and hunting firearms.

ANNEXURE A
FIREARM OWNER TRAVEL CHECKLIST

A practical pre-trip and overnight checklist. It supplements - and does not replace - the Firearms Control Act, Regulations or case-specific legal advice.

BEFORE DEPARTURE

1. ☐ Record the full accommodation address, responsible contact person and event contact; keep a copy somewhere other than only on your phone.
2. ☐ Save the nearest SAPS station details, nearest hospital or emergency facility, and the event or venue first-aid contact.
3. ☐ Keep your firearm make, model, calibre, serial number and licence particulars readily accessible for an emergency.
4. ☐ Confirm travel/off-premises insurance for the firearm, high-value optic, accessories, EDC handgun and, where applicable, ammunition; check specified values, excesses and security conditions.
5. ☐ If accommodation has been selected or booked for you, ask what security and lawful firearm-storage arrangements actually exist before you arrive.

AT THE ACCOMMODATION

1. ☐ Is a prescribed safe or strongroom storage available, and is it physically capable of accommodating the firearm - particularly a long rifle - without improvisation?
2. ☐ Who can access the storage? If another licence holder is to store your firearm, has the Regulation 86(4) / SAPS 539 arrangement been lawfully completed beforehand?
3. ☐ Check the room lock, windows and obvious access points, as well as alarms, external beams, perimeter security, CCTV and controlled access.
4. ☐ Do not treat a locked hard case, an ordinary cupboard or an unattended bedroom as a substitute for prescribed storage when direct control is absent.
5. ☐ If the firearm is bedside while you sleep, do not assume proximity alone establishes direct personal and physical control. Consider who can enter and reach it.
6. ☐ When moving to dining or common areas, re-assess control and storage. Do not leave a firearm unattended merely because the accommodation feels secure.

IF A FIREARM OR PHONE IS STOLEN

1. ☐ Report firearm loss or theft to the SAPS station nearest the place where it occurred within 24 hours after becoming aware of it; complete SAPS 521(f) and retain the CAS/case reference or acknowledgement.
2. ☐ Preserve the scene, photographs, original CCTV, witness details and evidence of entry and security. Do not disturb evidence unnecessarily.
3. ☐ If your phone is also stolen, use another device for urgent calls and preserve any available account, device-location, date/time or other original electronic information.
4. ☐ Keep the account factual. If negligent safekeeping or a section 102 process emerges, obtain competent firearm-law advice early.

Email: saga@saga.org.za
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SA GEWEERENAARS-ASSOSIASIE ★ SA GUNOWNERS' ASSOCIATION ★ SAGA

P O Box 35203
Northway, 4065
KwaZulu-Natal
South Africa

ANNEXURE B
EVENT ORGANISER / ACCOMMODATION PROVIDER CHECKLIST

A planning and accountability checklist for clubs, associations, Match Directors, venue owners and accommodation providers. Legal liability remains fact specific.

EVENT ORGANISER / MATCH DIRECTOR

1. ☐ Publish or brief the full accommodation address and responsible contact, nearest SAPS station, nearest hospital or emergency facility, first-aid location and emergency contacts.
2. ☐ Where accommodation is selected or recommended for competitors, verify what security and firearm-storage arrangements actually exist and communicate them accurately before arrival.
3. ☐ Clarify who is, and is not, assuming custody or storage responsibility. Hosting, sponsoring or recommending an event does not by itself make a dealer, club or other party the custodian of competitors' firearms.
4. ☐ If firearm storage is offered, confirm lawful capacity for the expected number and type of firearms, including long rifles. Do not leave this to improvised arrangements after arrival.
5. ☐ Ensure Match Directors, Range Officers and safety officials are competent and appropriately appointed for the applicable range and event requirements, with clear emergency procedures.
6. ☐ For larger events, use a written security and emergency plan covering accommodation, storage, transport, communications, medical response, SAPS liaison and preservation of evidence after an incident.
7. ☐ For international teams, confirm in advance with SAPS/CFR and other relevant authorities the applicable temporary import/authorisation, transport, storage and accommodation-information requirements, and brief teams before travel.

ACCOMMODATION PROVIDER / LANDOWNER

1. ☐ Assess security against the actual foreseeable risk created by hosting firearm owners and concentrated high-value equipment. An incident-free history is not, by itself, a security plan.
2. ☐ Review doors, locks, windows, access control, perimeter security, alarms, beams, CCTV, response arrangements and key/staff access before the event.
3. ☐ If firearm storage is represented as available, confirm that it is prescribed, secure, access-controlled and of sufficient size and capacity. Do not represent ordinary lockable rooms or cupboards as compliant storage.
4. ☐ Give organisers and guests accurate information about what security and storage is available, and what is not. Avoid assumptions created by the venue's association with a shooting event.
5. ☐ Have an incident-response process: immediate SAPS notification where required, preservation of CCTV and access records, protection of the scene and a responsible person available to assist investigators.

ACCOUNTABILITY PRINCIPLE

The firearm owner remains responsible for personal statutory safeguarding. Organisers, officials, venue owners and accommodation providers should identify and manage the risks they actually control or have undertaken. For major events, those separate responsibilities should be defined before competitors arrive - not after something has gone wrong.

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SOUTH AFRICAN GUNOWNERS' ASSOCIATION

Responsible Ownership | Education | Advocacy | Representation

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Your Firearm. Your Responsibility. Our Collective Voice.

Responsible firearm ownership requires competence, care and compliance. Its future also depends on the laws being written, the regulations being proposed and how those laws are administered. These decisions affect every lawful owner, together with the clubs, associations and businesses that support them. They require informed, credible and sustained representation. For more than four decades, SAGA has helped provide that voice.

Who Is SAGA?

Established in 1985, the South African Gunowners' Association (SAGA) is an independent, non-profit and non-party political association representing the interests of South Africa's law-abiding firearms community.

We support lawful firearm ownership and use for self-defence, hunting, sport shooting, recreation, collecting and legitimate business purposes. We promote responsible ownership and unequivocally oppose firearm misuse and abuse.

Our objective is a regulatory environment that is fair, workable, properly administered and grounded in evidence, one that confronts criminal misuse while respecting responsible citizens. Responsible firearm ownership, effective policing and public safety belong together.

The Work Behind The Scenes

Effective advocacy begins long before a proposal reaches the headlines and continues after public attention moves elsewhere. It requires examining legislation, preparing submissions, maintaining relationships and following issues through.

SAGA engages at the highest levels, with Parliament, the Portfolio Committee on Police, the Civilian Secretariat for Police Service, SAPS and other stakeholders on matters affecting lawful firearm ownership. We scrutinise proposed legislation and regulations, challenge unjustified restrictions, contribute research and public commentary, and advocate for fair administrative processes.

Where systemic administrative failures affect groups of firearm owners, SAGA has pursued collective legal action. Our focus is on the **laws, rights and administrative systems** that affect the entire firearm community.

How Does That Help You?

Legislation and regulation shape your ability to acquire, retain and lawfully use firearms. Poor administration and regulatory uncertainty can affect your sport, livelihood, business and ability to exercise lawful choices. SAGA brings those interests into discussions where individual owners may otherwise have little opportunity to be heard.

Our Factsheets, opinion editorials, podcasts, articles and legislative updates also make complex requirements more understandable, helping owners remain informed about their responsibilities and proposed changes. SAGA's legal advocacy centres on firearm legislation, regulation, administrative law and collective challenges. **We are an advocacy association, not a law firm or an emergency criminal-defence service**.

Why Join SAGA As Well As Your Existing Association?

Your hunting or sporting association supports your activities and, where applicable, your dedicated status. Those affiliations remain important. SAGA membership supports broader representation on the **laws and regulatory decisions affecting lawful firearm ownership across disciplines.**

Hunters, sport shooters, collectors, self-defence owners, trainers and dealers have different needs, but share an interest in fair legislation, sound administration and recognition of responsible ownership. Your existing affiliation and SAGA membership serve complementary purposes. Together, they strengthen the community.

Working Together Across The Sector

SAGA builds alliances with clubs, associations, businesses and legal specialists, respecting each organisation's independence while working on common concerns. We challenge misconceptions about lawful firearm owners and advocate for policy that addresses crime, illicit firearms, trafficking and misuse. Through membership of the World Forum on Shooting Activities (WFSA), SAGA, Africa's only member, also contributes a South African and African perspective to international firearms-policy discussions.

A Large Community Needs A Strong Collective Voice

The lawful firearms sector extends far beyond individual owners. It includes families, clubs, associations, dealers, trainers, ranges and businesses whose livelihoods depend on it. The size of a community does not automatically translate into the strength of its lobby. That strength grows when individuals and organisations add their membership, expertise, resources and voices to sustained representation.

Clubs, firearm associations and businesses can help turn the sector's scale into meaningful influence: join SAGA, encourage members and customers to join alongside their existing affiliations, share reliable information and support coordinated engagement on common concerns.

This gives SAGA a stronger representative base from which to challenge unjustified restrictions, contribute informed submissions and press for fair legislation and accountable administration.

Each organisation retains its independence. Together, we carry greater weight.

Who Can Join?

SAGA welcomes individual firearm owners and people who support lawful firearm ownership, including pensioners, as well as clubs, businesses and associations. Whether your interest is personal, sporting or commercial, your membership supports representation across the lawful firearms sector.

Why Your Membership Matters

Advocacy requires expertise, resources and persistence. Your membership helps sustain the education, engagement and collective action needed to defend responsible firearm ownership. Do not wait until a proposed restriction affects you personally to support the voice challenging it. Add your weight. Add your voice. Help us help you - and strengthen the sector we all depend on.

Responsible ownership is your commitment. Standing up for it is ours. Join SAGA. Strengthen Our Collective Voice.

Join SAGA INDIVIDUAL

Join SAGA CORPORATE

Use QR codes above or visit **www.saga.org.za** for membership categories, current fees and application details. Email **membership@saga.org.za** or call 031 562 9951.

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BARRETT

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VANWARD

▲ **SA Protea F-Open Rifle Team**
Front Row: L to R: Bernard Engelbrecht, Chrisjan Diedericks, Johan Maritz (Coach), Herme Smit (Manager), Jan Swanepoel (Captain), Alexander Coetzee (Coach), Dr. Stefan Steyn, Carel Du Plessis.
Second row: L to R: Victor Terblanche, Jason Terblanche, Kolver Mulke, Stefan Koekemoer, Rob Lishman, Werner Prinsloo, Frikkie Coetzee, Andrew Toy.

7th F-CLASS WORLD CHAMPIONSHIP BISELY (UK) 2026

By Jan Swanepoel

From a five-point heartbreak in Bloemfontein, Free State to the top of the podium at the historic home of British full-bore.

What a couple of years it has been. When we packed up in Bloemfontein in April 2023, having just shot the F-Class World Championship on home soil, there was already a feeling in the South African F-Open community that the next event would be different. Normally a World Championship campaign gives a team four years to prepare. This time we had three.

The championship was originally scheduled for 2021 but due to COVID-19 was initially postponed to 2022 and subsequently to 2023. Due to the six-year gap from 2017 it was decided to have the next championship a year earlier, effectively leaving only a three-year preparation period.

The next championship was scheduled for Bisley, UK from 10 to 16 August 2026, so there was no time to sit back and enjoy the last one. The clock had started, and for me the real work began almost immediately.

Five points

Bloemfontein showed us just how small the margins are at the top of international F-Open shooting. The United States won the team match and we finished second. The gap was five points. According to the official International Confederation of Full-Bore Rifle Associations (ICFRA) report, it was an exceptionally close contest.

Australia led South Africa by a single point after the first day, with the USA eight points behind. We went into the final 900 m range tied with the Americans, who then handled the conditions slightly better and won by five.

Being close is not the same as winning.

Five points, after two days of shooting: thousands of individual shots, over multiple distances, from multiple shooters, with coaches reading constantly changing wind. That number stayed with us. It was not a huge gap, which made it both encouraging and frustrating. Being close is not the same as winning.

It was not a massive gap that needed to be overcome. It was a handful of wind calls, a few dropped points, one range slightly better managed than the next. We knew that if we wanted to arrive at Bisley with a genuine chance of winning, the preparation had to start immediately.

The three-year challenge

Bisley changed the equation. For many South African shooters it is almost a pilgrimage, the historic home of full-bore shooting, and it presents conditions very different from what we know at home. We had to learn the range, the weather and how our equipment performed there.

We had to get better at reading conditions and, above all, become a better team. Having eight excellent shooters was not enough. We needed a team that could function under World Championship pressure.

That meant practice camps, and lots of them. It meant testing and retesting equipment, and finding ammunition that would perform at a completely different altitude and in different weather. It meant developing the rhythm between each shooter and wind coach and fixing weaknesses before we got to Britain.

The clock, in other words, never stopped. There was no long rest after 2023 and no easing into the cycle. Every camp, every match and every conversation over a rifle or a load was aimed at a particular date in August 2026.

Hundreds of small decisions were made.

There was never a moment when we could say, “Right, we are ready.” Hundreds of small decisions were made, from rifle preparation to ammunition testing, coaching, travel planning, selection, then more practice, more testing and more coaching. We also learned from every international competition our members shot in.

One of the most valuable was the 2025 European Championship in the UK, where we fielded a full eight-man South African team. We won gold in the European Rutland Team Match and silver in the Americas Match, but as management the medals were almost secondary. The British weather was our best teacher. Rain, and wind that could change from one detail to the next, was an education for shooters raised on hot, dry mirage. That was exactly why we were there.

▲ The 1000 Yards, Stickledown range, Bisley

Bisley 2026

The National Shooting Centre’s Stickledown range hosted the seventh F-Class World Championships from 10 to 16 August 2026, with the British Open Championship immediately prior from 3 to 8 August. That made the campaign effectively a two-week operation: the British Open as our final test, followed by the individual championship, then the team match. Somewhere in between, I had to keep the team focused, healthy and together.

We arrived on the Saturday before the British Open, and the weather was not the Britain many of us had imagined. It was hot, with temperatures in the high thirties, much closer to home than the wet conditions we had seen the year before.

There was equipment to sort out and rifles to prepare, and for some of the team it was a first chance simply to walk around Bisley and take in the range. The range was ready. The team was ready. Or at least, we believed we were. Now we had to find out.

▲ Very dry and different conditions to what the SA Team were expecting

▲ Jan Swanepoel - Team Captain

The British Open: A final warning

The British Open was our shakedown. The international F-Open team match gave us our first real read on the opposition. The United States won with 1 718 points, New Zealand's 1 677 points secured them second, and we were third with 1 675. Two points off second was close, but the Americans were 43 points clear, a huge margin in this format.

It was not the result we had travelled for, but it was valuable. It showed how quickly margins open up when conditions are difficult and you do not manage them perfectly, and it gave us one last chance to fix things. That is the nature of a shakedown. Better to learn it in the British Open than in the World Championship, and better to feel the sting while there was still time to act on it.

The ability and depth were apparent.

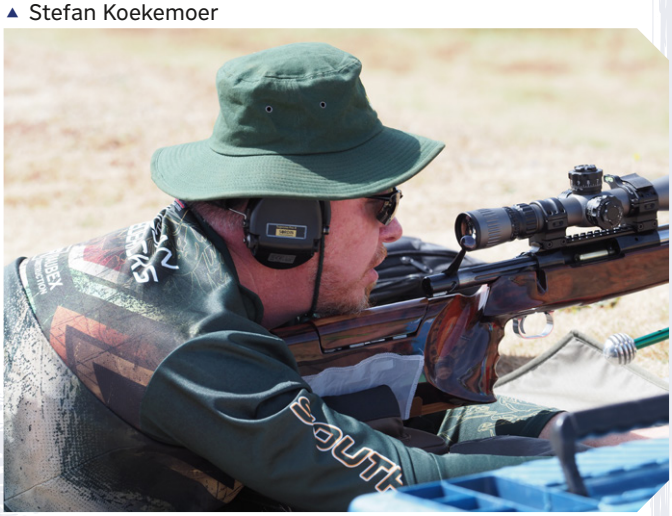
There were encouraging individual performances too. **Dr. Stefan Steyn** took third in the British Open individual F-Open Championship and the NRA bronze medal. **Chrisjan Diedericks** finished eighth, **Carel du Plessis** 11th, **Stefan Koekemoer** 15th and **Victor Terblanche** 16th. The ability and depth were apparent. Now we had to turn individual performances into a team performance.

Choosing the eight

We had twelve shooters but only eight could shoot the team match. The other four would still play important roles in the wider team operation, but selection was one of the hardest decisions of the campaign. Choosing who would carry the team's hopes onto the firing line, and who would support from behind it, was never going to be comfortable, and I will not pretend it was.

▲ Alexander Coetzee

▲ Stefan Koekemoer



▲ Chrisjan Deidericks

▲ Frikkie Coetzee

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▲ Dr. Stefan Steyn

▲ Victor Terblanche

There were obviously some very disappointed shooters but we all knew at the end only eight members would shoot. They gave their full support and assumed their duties with passion. This to me was the one real thing that made us such a formidable team, as everyone worked together, no matter the role they played.

Team manager **Herme Smit** and I, together with our two coaches, also decided to change our approach on the final practice day. We pushed the shooters to shoot at a much higher tempo, firing quickly whenever conditions allowed. Conditions can change at any moment, so you want as many points on the board as possible while the window is open. We also wanted the pressure to become familiar. The idea was simple: make the pressure normal before it became real.

▲ Herme Smit - Team Manager

On that practice day we wanted to create pressure deliberately, and we wanted the shooters to feel what it is like to get points on the board quickly when the wind allows, because you never know what the conditions will do next. By the end of the day, we were happy, and the team was coming together.

▲ In image, L to R: Victor Terblanche, Johan Maritz, Bernard Engelbrecht, Jan Swanepoel, Dr. Stefan Steyn

▲ The final 1000 yards next to the USA team

Six in the world's top 20

The individual World Championship came first, with three days of shooting scheduled.

Unfortunately, Vito Bosco, an F-Open member of the Italian Team, collapsed on the range on his way to the 800-yard firing points shortly before shooting was due to commence on Day 1 of the individual FCWC. He sadly passed away despite the prompt attendance of the NRA staff, followed by advanced medical support from emergency response and an air ambulance. The Match Committee took the difficult decision to cancel shooting for the rest of the day.

On behalf of the South African F Class community, we are deeply saddened by the passing of Vito Bosco. We extend our heartfelt condolences to his family, friends and his teammates on the Italian Team.

The next two days of individual shooting gave us perhaps the clearest sign yet of our depth. Six South Africans finished in the top 20 out of 212 F Open contestants:

6th: Herme Smit
8th: Dr. Stefan Steyn
10th: Jan Swanepoel
11th: Chrisjan Diedericks
18th: Stefan Koekemoer
20th: Victor Terblanche

Positions three to ten earn bronze medals at the FCWC, so South Africa had three individual World Championship bronze medallists. At the very front, though, the Americans showed their strength and swept the podium: Brandon Zwahr won, Matthew Basalla was second and Emil Kovan third.

Three years of work came down to two days of shooting.

It was a strong return for a team whose real target lay a day later, and it told us that the depth we had built was real and not just a hope. But we had not come to win an individual title. We had come for the team championship. The individual match was over. The real test was about to begin, and three years of work came down to two days of shooting.

Friday: A braai, not a barbecue

Effectively the Friday before the Team Shoot was a 'free' day for the 16-man international teams. It was the day the 8 Man Rutland teams (for countries that could not field a full 16-man team) shot their team match at Bisley.

We had been away from home for nearly two weeks, and homesickness was creeping in. So, on the Friday we did something very South African: we had a braai. Not a barbecue. A braai. Luckily there was a South African butcher a few kilometres from the range, and the military clubhouse at Bisley has braai facilities.

Boerewors, ***skaap*** chops, a few beers a ***Klippies*** and Coke and a group of South Africans around a fire. It sounds insignificant next to a World Championship, but team management is about more than scores and rifles. Sometimes you need to take the pressure away and remind people why they are there. That day brought the team back together. The next morning, the pressure would return.

Day One: The wind arrived

Two days of shooting would decide it all: the preparation, the training camps, the travel, and the sacrifices of shooters and their families. The wind, heat and humidity were up again. For some nations that would have been unwelcome news, but the heavy air, mirage and wind suited us better than the mild British days we had prepared for.

Two wind coaches were our secret weapon.

We also had two wind coaches in whom we had enormous confidence, one of whom had travelled to Bisley twenty years in a row and another with six Protea tours under his belt. They were our secret weapon.

A World Championship team match is not a normal range day. Eight shooters, two coaches on the wind and team management all must hold a single plan together while the conditions keep rewriting it. We had spent three years practising exactly that.

At 800 yd we dropped points. It was more than we would have liked, but the conditions were difficult and changing rapidly. At 900 yd it got harder still, and this is where our coaches began to make a real difference. The shooters found their rhythm, the coaches read the conditions, and the system worked.

▲ A look at the team shoot. This is about a quarter of the field.

Then came 1 000 yd, with the wind rapidly and significantly changing between shots. Every shot demanded concentration and every decision mattered. The shooters had to trust the coaches, and the coaches had to read a constantly moving picture.

Shot after shot, it worked. This is where the shooter and coach combinations we had built over three years counted most: a shooter trusting the call, a coach committing to it, and the next detail doing the same.

When the last shot at 1 000 yd had been fired and the scores were tallied, we were 25 points ahead of the United States. Nobody in the team believed for a second that it was over. Anyone who has spent enough time at 1 000 yd knows that 25 points can disappear very quickly.

Day Two: The longest 100 yd

On Sunday morning the flags were hanging almost motionless. The wind had largely disappeared, and it was going to be a very different day. Nice cool temperatures with a crystal-clear sight picture and flat conditions bring their own pressure. When the wind disappears, points are there to be shot, and every dropped point is a real loss rather than a forgivable one.

At 800 yd we shot an outstanding 599 out of 600. The USA also dropped one, so our 25-point lead stayed intact. At 900 yd conditions began to change, and our final shooter produced a remarkable 75/75, which stretched the gap to 28 points.

One distance remained. Anyone who has shot at Bisley knows the stretch from 900 yd to 1,000 yd can feel like the longest 100 yd in the world. We started well, but as we neared the end the pressure increased.

A five brought relief. A V-bull elicited cheers. A shot just outside the five ring resulted in a groan. Then the wind began to turn and we found ourselves in horrible twitchy weather conditions, with two shooters left.

Eventually I made the call. Let's go!

We had to make a call as to wait or shoot? Waiting for conditions to improve could just as easily mean waiting for them to get worse. Eventually I made the call. Let's go! Those last two shooters dropped 14 points, more than half of what the previous six shooters had dropped combined.

But the conditions were brutal, with the wind changing direction and increasing in strength. We watched, waited and calculated. Then the final shot fell. I knew we had done enough. The United States could not make up 28 points in those conditions. Still, until the scores were officially tallied, nobody was celebrating.

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The final official team result:

Farquharson Cup: F-Open Team World Championship, FCWC 2026 (Bisley, UK)
Maximum 3 600 points. Scores shown as points. V-bulls (e.g. 593.64 v = 593 points, 64 V-bulls), as in the official ICFRA results.

Rank	Country	Day 1 800 yds	Day 1 900 yds	Day 1 1000 yds	Day 2 800 yds	Day 2 900 yds	Day 2 1000 yds	Total
1	South Africa	593.64v	578.41v	574.30v	599.87v	593.70v	563.36v	**3500.328v**
2	USA	589.60v	571.35v	560.33v	599.96v	590.69v	573.42v	**3482.335v**
3	Australia	589.65v	562.25v	555.32v	600.92v	597.72v	553.36v	**3456.322v**
4	Great Britain	591.58v	566.43v	548.35v	600.88v	600.78v	541.24v	**3446.326v**
5	Republic of Ireland	592.55v	556.35v	549.30v	594.69v	587.53v	543.30v	**3421.272v**
6	New Zealand	575.41v	560.35v	538.20v	599.80v	592.61v	543.32v	**3407.269v**
7	Poland	583.51v	542.28v	536.25v	599.78v	585.51v	531.25v	**3376.258v**
8	Canada	564.41v	531.25v	556.34v	592.77v	588.50v	543.27v	**3374.254v**
9	Italy	576.42v	554.25v	521.23v	595.66v	583.48v	542.26v	**3371.230v**
10	Germany	575.57v	542.29v	539.26v	597.79v	593.66v	522.22v	**3368.279v**

▲ Top 10 individuals: L to R: Dr. Stefan Steyn, 8th, Herme Smit, 6th and Jan Swanepoel, 10th.

We won by 18 points over the United States and by 44 points over Australia. But standing there after two days of shooting, the numbers were almost secondary. We had come to Bisley to win a World Championship, and we had done it.

In Bloemfontein in 2023 we were five points short and the question was simply can we go and do it in Bisley after coming so close? The historic home of British full-bore gave us our answer. This time the entire team delivered and the margin went our went our way.

The road between those two results was not a straight line. It was years of preparation, mistakes, lessons learned, equipment development, ammunition testing, travel, practice camps, difficult conversations and pressure. Most importantly, it was a group of South Africans learning to work and shoot as one team. The real difference between 2023 and 2026 was not on the scoreboard. It was in the team.

A moment of thanks

Before the celebrations really began, we formed a circle and gave thanks to our Heavenly Father for the opportunity, the ability to compete, safe travel, for the people who supported us all the way and the result.

Winning a World Championship is never the achievement of a 16-man team alone. Behind every shooter are families, friends, coaches, supporters and sponsors (ADG, Rhenus Logistics, Normark Africa, Safari Outdoor, Leads 2 Business, CMH Precision.) Some gave money, time and equipment. Some sent messages when things were difficult.

Others waited at home while their husbands, fathers and friends spent weeks on the other side of the world. All believed in this team long before anybody knew the final score. To all of you, thank you. Nobody wins at this level alone, and I would be failing as captain if I let this account read as though we did.

◀ Thanking our Lord for the opportunity and precious time together as a team.

▲ Winning F Open 2026 Team. Triumphant to the end. Phil Harrison, previous Secretary General of ICFRA, an honorary guest presented the medals and trophy.

▲ The F-Class World Championships – The Farquharson Cup

At the international level governed by the International Confederation of Full-bore Rifle Associations (ICFRA), the Farquharson Cup is the premier trophy awarded to the winning 16-person team in the F-Open Class.

World Champions

The individual championship showed the strength of the American shooters. But when it became a true team contest, with two days, three distances each day, eight shooters on the line and coaches reading the wind, South Africa produced what we had spent three years preparing for.

Eighteen points is far more than a margin on a scoreboard. It stands for the three-year journey that began right after Bloemfontein, every practice camp, rifle adjustment and ammunition test, every kilometre travelled and every hour away from home, every family sacrifice, every coach's call, every shooter who trusted the process and every person who stood behind the team.

In 2023, we were five points short. In 2026, at Bisley, we were 18 points ahead. We went to Bisley to win the F-Open World Championship. We came home as World Champions. That is what three years of work looks like when it finally comes together on the scoreboard. What an absolute honour it has been to captain this amazing team!

South African Bisley Union

Contact Details:
South African Bisely Union
Website:
https://sabisley.com/

2026 Western Province Open Bisley Championship

By Rick Jaffe, Chairman

The 72nd annual Western Province Open Bisley Championships were held at the home of the Western Province Bisley Association (WPBA), the Good Hope Shooting Range near Melkbosstrand on the Cape West Coast, from 1 to 3 October.

Over three days of competition, the Cape weather lived up to its reputation. Shooters had to contend with heat, rain, extreme and fishtailing winds as well as heavy mirage. Each day presented its own challenges, demanding concentration, discipline and the ability to read and react to constantly changing conditions.

Except for .22 LR and Black Powder, all the Bisley classes and disciplines competed. These ranged from hi-tech, custom-built F-Open, F-TR and Target Rifles, through factory-manufactured F-Sporting rifles, to the venerable 303, the stalwart service rifle of the British and Commonwealth forces in both World Wars. In addition to the Western Cape stalwarts, competitors travelled from Germany, Namibia, Gauteng and the Eastern Cape to take part in the championships.

Four distances were shot during each day of the championship, ranging from 300 m to 800 m. Across the three days, competitors fired 130 scoring shots, together with the applicable sighters, bringing the total number of rounds fired by each competitor to 156. Maintaining concentration and consistency over such a demanding programme is no easy task, and several medals were ultimately decided by a single V Bull.

The standard of competition was exceptionally high, particularly in the F-Open, F-TR and Target Rifle disciplines. Current and former members of the South African national team took many of the top positions. In F-Open, first and third places went to competitors who, just six weeks earlier, had been members of the South African team that won the World Championship at the historic National Shooting Centre at Bisley in the United Kingdom.

Given the conditions served up by the Cape over the three days, even the very best shooters had to call upon all their skill and experience to keep shot after shot in the centre of the target.

Opening Day

As is customary, the first day began with an official opening by the Chairman. This included information on the running of the championship, fouling shots, the essential safety briefing, and the reading of Scripture followed by a prayer by Oom Fanie Brits.

The Western Province Championships consist of 11 matches, with the combined scores determining the overall winner in each discipline. In addition, there are four aggregate competitions, including the prestigious Administrator's Cup.

The range was then handed over to **Ian Noble-Jack**, Head Range Officer. Ian was ably assisted by **Amanda Van Niekerk** and **Malcolm Goslin**. The Range Officers did a fantastic job throughout the three days, playing a vital role in ensuring safety on the range while keeping every match on time and in accordance with the programme.

With the Range Officers firmly in charge, the serious business of deciding the 2026 Western Province Championship in F-Open, F-TR, F-Sporting, TR Open, TR B and 303 could begin. After extreme heat on Wednesday, when the range was prepared and the pre-Championship Team Match decided, Thursday was overcast with relatively mild winds during the morning. After lunch, however, the wind increased and became considerably bumpier.

Competitors were given the opportunity to fire fouling shots before the start of each day's matches. These shots could not be fired at the targets and were intended solely to foul and warm the barrels. The targets used for all disciplines were the same size, with competitors firing the same number of shots from the same distances. The major difference was the size of the scoring rings.

In F-Class, the rings are about ½ MOA for a V Bull, 1 MOA for a 5, 2 MOA for a 4 and 4 MOA for a 3. Target Rifle, which is shot using iron sights without the support of a bipod or rear bag, has scoring rings about twice the size of those used in F-Class. Its V Bull measures about 1 MOA, while the 5 measures 2 MOA and the 4 about 6 MOA.

Most competitors shot on electronic targets, with only the 303 matches using manually operated targets, where the shots are marked by hand. The electronic targets use microphones to detect the position of each bullet strike and transmit the exact point of impact and score directly to the competitor's phone or tablet.

For the first time, the organisers were able to squad full disciplines on the same detail. This eliminated inconsistencies caused by competitors shooting in different weather conditions and provided the fairest possible competitive environment. At lunchtime and again each evening, the scores were displayed in the clubhouse, adding another element of pressure as competitors could see exactly where they stood.

▲ Rick Jaffe – presenting the safety and match briefing

▲ 2nd October at 09:25

The course of fire on Thursday consisted of two non-convertible sighters followed by two convertible sighters and ten to count at 300 m. This was followed by two convertible sighters and ten to count at 500 m. After the lunch break, competitors returned to the range for *matches* at 600 m and 700 m, with the same number of sighters and counting shots.

Friday

Friday proved to be the least windy day of the championship, although rain made intermittent appearances throughout the day. The day's programme was like Thursday, with two convertible sighters followed by ten to count at 300 m, 500 m and 600 m.

▲ Jaco van Tonder

▲ Rick Jaffe

▲ Andries de Klerk

▲ Chrisjan Diedericks

▲ Rhynier Burger

▲ Billy Neumann

▲ Andre du Toit

▲ Dawie van der Westhuizen

The only change was that the final match was shot at 800 m rather than 700 m. By the time competitors reached the 800 m match, the wind had increased considerably, providing a fittingly difficult conclusion to the day's shooting.

Saturday: The Final Day

The final day, Saturday 3 October, produced some of the most challenging conditions of the championship. Strong winds damaged some of the targets, necessitating repairs during the day's programme. Despite these interruptions, the competition continued with competitors shooting two convertible sighters followed by ten to count at 700 m, repeated at 800 m.

After lunch came the final match of the championship, the Scottie Kerr. The Scottie is shot with two convertible sighters followed by 15 to count at 700 m and a further two convertibles and 15 at 800 m. It provides a demanding final test for shooters, with the championship titles still hanging in the balance, ensuring that the competition went right down to the final shots.

▲ Victor Terblanche

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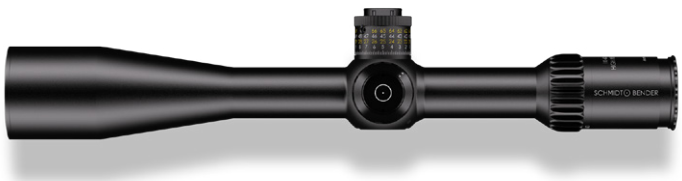
M1FL reticle



TECHNICAL DATA	
Length (mm / in)	442/17.402
Main tube diameter (mm / in)	34/1.34
Weight (g / oz)	940-998/33.16-35.20
Focal Plane	1
Field-of-view (m/100 m) I (ft/100 yd)*	4.42-0.75/13.3-2.3
Outer diameter objective (mm / in)	62/2.441
Outer diameter ocular (mm / in)	50/1.969

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▲ Amanda van Niekerk - Range Officer

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▲ Jaco van Tonder

▲ Rhynier Burger

The Tradition of Chairing the Winner

One of the most distinctive traditions associated with Bisley shooting is the chairing of the winner. Following victory, the winner is placed in a chair and carried from the range by fellow competitors. Until this year, this honour had traditionally been reserved for Target Rifle competitors. In 2026, however, the tradition was extended to include the F-Open winner.

In the Western Cape, the tradition lives on through the Administrator's Cup, which forms part of the annual Western Province Bisley Championship. The Administrator's is an aggregate competition based on the scores achieved in five designated matches.

At the prizegiving in the clubhouse, F-Open winner **Dawie Van Der Westhuizen** and Target Rifle winner **Johann Ahrens** were carried into the proceedings by their fellow competitors, a fitting acknowledgement of their sporting achievement and Bisley tradition.

Prizegiving and the 2026 Champions

Prizegiving took place in the clubhouse, with gold medals awarded to the winners of each individual match in each discipline. Gold, silver and bronze medals were awarded for the aggregate competitions and the overall championships.

The Western Province Bisley Champions are the competitors who achieved the highest aggregate score across all the counting matches in their respective disciplines. Where competitors finished on equal points, the number of V Bulls was used to determine the final placing.

▲ Mark Timm of AutoX presenting the prize to Victor Terblanche

▲ F-Open: Gold, Victor Terblanche

▲ F Open Administrators' Cup: Winner Dawie van der Westhuizen (on the chair)

▲ L to R: F-TR: Werner Brits, Billy Van Rooyen and Julius Hartmann

▲ F-TR: Gold, Julius Hartmann

2026
Western Province Bisley Champions

Discipline	Gold	Silver	Bronze
F-Open	Victor Terblanche	Dawie Van Der Westhuizen	Chrisjan Diedericks
F-TR	Julius Hartmann	Billy Van Rooyen	Werner Brits
F-Sporting	Rick Jaffe	Jan Smit	Pieter Dirk Fourie
TR Open	Johann Ahrens	Jason Di Bona	Graeme Leon
TR B	Phillip Du Toit	Tjaart Muller	Pieter Truter
.303	Jochen Mathes (GER)	Sean McKeag	Giepie Engelbrecht
Ladies	Melani Di Bona		

▲ L to R: F-Sporting: Pieter Dirk Fourie, Rick Jaffe and Jan Smit

The 2026 Western Province Open Bisley Championship once again demonstrated what makes Bisley such a demanding and enduring sport. Modern rifles, electronic targets and highly refined equipment may have changed the way some competitors approach the discipline. However, the fundamentals of marksmanship, concentration, discipline and the ability to read the wind and conditions remain unchanged.

For three days, competitors from across the disciplines faced everything the Cape could throw at them. In the end, the champions were those who managed to combine technical ability with experience, consistency and the ability to perform when conditions were at their most difficult.

▲ F Sporting: Gold, Rick Jaffe

▲ TR Open: Gold, Johann Ahrens

▲ TR: Winner Administrators' Cup, Johann Ahrens (on the chair)

▲ L to R: TR Open: Johann Ahrens, Graeme Leon and Jason Di Bona

▲ L to R: Johann Ahrens and Phillip du Toit

▲ .303 Winner, Gold: Jochen Mathes

▲ TR - Melani Di Bona wins Lorraine Goslin Ladies trophy

Bisley Shooting in the Western Cape

South African Bisley Union

For anyone interested in shooting Bisley, matches are usually held on both the first and third Saturday of most months at the Good Hope Shooting Range at Atlantis. This includes .308 Target Rifle (A and B classes), F Open, FTR, F Sporting and Black Powder shooting alongside each other.

.22LR Long Range and .303 club competitions are also held once a month.

New members are always welcome, so if you think Bisley-style shooting may be for you, please visit the Western Province Association website at **www.wpbisley.co.za** or Email: **thesecretarywpba@gmail.com**.

If you are not in the Western Cape, visit the SA Bisley website at **www.sabisley.com**

Whatever Bisley discipline you decide to shoot, you will be warmly welcomed on the range!

PROTEAS ON TARGET:

IPRF Centrefire World Championship

By Clive Mey, SA National Team Manager, IPRF 2026

Clive Mey - Team Manager

Looking back at the 2026 IPRF Precision Rifle World Championship in Texas, USA from 23 to 28 September, it is difficult to describe the experience without an enormous sense of pride. As Team Manager, I had the privilege of watching South African shooters compete against some of the best precision rifle competitors in the world, and the performances across our teams were nothing short of spectacular.

We were privileged to achieve four podium wins in the face of considerable international pressure:

Ladies: 3rd Overall

Juniors: 2nd Overall

Limited: 2nd Overall

Seniors: 2nd Overall

We travelled to the USA knowing that the standard would be exceptionally high. A World Championship is supposed to test you, and this event certainly did. The stages demanded solid positional shooting, good time management, the ability to read conditions and, probably most importantly, the ability to remain composed when things did not go according to plan.

What became very clear was that South African precision rifle shooting belongs on the world stage.

Many of the barricades and shooting positions were familiar to our competitors because they were like what we regularly encounter at PRS matches back home. That itself says a great deal about the standard of match design and competition in South Africa.

The difference of a World Championship is the pressure. Every point matters, the depth of talent is extraordinary, and you are competing alongside shooters who are at the very top of the sport.

Overall performance of Team South Africa

Our shooters handled that pressure exceptionally well. There were brilliant individual performances, but for me the greatest achievement was the overall performance of South Africa. Our results demonstrated the depth of talent we have developed and the tremendous amount of work that has gone into precision rifle shooting in our country.

SA had the second-highest access ratio on the scoring platform.

The support from South Africa was equally remarkable. One of our shooters was informed by Impact Scoring that South Africa had the second-highest access ratio on the scoring platform during the World Championship.

For a country thousands of kilometres away from Texas, that says something special about our precision rifle community. People back home were following stages, watching scores and supporting our shooters throughout the competition. The team might have been standing on a range in Texas, but we certainly never felt that we were there alone.

▲ Ladies: 3rd Overall

Thank you to the supporters

A special thank you must also go to the wives, husbands, partners, family members and supporters who travelled with us and were alongside the shooters throughout the competition. Their contribution can easily be overlooked when attention is focused on the person behind the rifle.

They endured the same long days, Texas heat, early mornings and late finishes. They carried equipment, made sure shooters had food and water, helped with logistics, kept an eye on scores and, most importantly, provided encouragement when a stage had not gone according to plan. Their presence and support on the various shooting days played a very real part in the success of our teams.

The World Championship was, however, about far more than results. The hospitality we received in Texas was exceptional. The team at Gravestone Precision Shooting presented a truly world-class facility and championship. The ranges, stages and infrastructure were outstanding, but even more impressive were the people behind it. Nothing ever seemed too much trouble, whether assisting competitors, resolving problems or simply making international visitors feel welcome.

▲ Juniors: 2nd Overall. L to R: Conner Britnell, Tinus Cronje, Donovan Cook and Johan Nel.

▲ Juniors: 2nd Overall

▲ Limited: 2nd Overall

▲ Seniors: 2nd Overall

An international community

The same must be said about the Range Officers, match officials, volunteers and everyone working behind the scenes. Long days, Texas heat and competitors from around the world created an enormous challenge, yet we were consistently met with professionalism, enthusiasm and a genuine love for the sport.

Another highlight was the relationship between the competing nations. We arrived as competitors proudly representing our respective countries, but quickly realised that precision rifle shooting has created a remarkable international community. There was fierce competition when the timer started, but away from the firing line there was friendship, laughter, advice, encouragement and tremendous mutual respect.

To our South African shooters: you represented your country with distinction. Wearing the Protea carries responsibility, and the way our competitors conducted themselves, both on and off the range, made me immensely proud. To our families, supporters, SAPRF leadership and everyone back home who followed and supported us, thank you. You were part of this journey and part of this success.

SA to host 2028 IPRF World Championship.

And now we have something very special to look forward to. In 2028, it will be our turn to welcome the precision rifle world to South Africa when we host the next IPRF World Championships.

Texas has set a high standard, and we return home with tremendous respect for what it takes to host an event of this magnitude. We also return with excitement about the opportunity to showcase South African precision rifle shooting, our ranges, our people and, most importantly, our uniquely South African hospitality.

To our hosts in Texas and our fellow competitors from around the world: thank you for an unforgettable World Championship. We came to Texas proudly South African. We returned home even prouder – and in 2028, we look forward to welcoming the world to South Africa!

J C Roberston – 2nd Limited Division 2026 IPRF World Championship

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METAL MAYHEM PROJECT:

South Africa's Steel Revolution

By Adrian Burrows

There is a particular moment in practical shooting when a match stops feeling like simply another day at the range. The equipment is familiar. The safety briefing is complete. Magazines are loaded, holsters checked and competitors are waiting their turn. Then the timer sounds, the first shot breaks and everything suddenly becomes about movement, decision-making, accuracy, time and a symphony of sound. That is the environment in which South Africa's Metal Mayhem Project has been building its identity.

There are plenty of shooting competitions on the South African calendar. There are handgun matches, PCC matches, rifle competitions, shotgun events, all of which have become part of the country's sporting-shooting landscape. What makes the Metal Mayhem concept worth examining is the effort to turn an individual match into something with its own identity.

Competitive shooting is fundamentally a participation sport. The challenge for event organisers is therefore to create a competition that is sufficiently serious for experienced competitors while retaining an atmosphere that encourages both competitors and spectators to come back. It is not IPSC, nor IDPA nor even a regular Steel Challenge match. It is a mixture of all three. Metal Mayhem has built a recognisable identity around steel, speed and the experience of the match itself.

Steel targets ... Lots of them!

The concept is deceptively simple. Rather than making steel merely one component of a conventional practical-shooting match, Metal Mayhem makes it the central character. The event describes itself in three words: Steel. Speed. Mayhem.

The attraction is immediately apparent to anyone who has spent time on a practical-shooting range. Paper targets have their place. They provide the scoring precision required by modern practical competition. But steel introduces an entirely different sensory component. A successful hit produces an immediate and unmistakable result.

There is the report of the shot, followed by the distinctive rewarding metallic ***clang***. Misses are equally unforgiving. The competitor knows, the Range Officer knows, and the spectators know, too. That creates a very different atmosphere from a conventional paper-target match.

Established in 2021, Metal Mayhem has just presented its sixth annual event from 26 to 27 September at the Magnum United Shooting Range in Pretoria. Originally a collaboration between Magnum and Smoking Barrels Shooting Club, Magnum United has hosted every Metal Mayhem since its inception.

▲ Metal Mayhem is an event for all. Ladies and gents, young and old, all came to participate in the competition

SA's largest steel-target-only competition.

Its dedicated staff and volunteers put in countless hours to build and prepare each stage to an international-quality standard. The organisers describe Metal Mayhem as South Africa's largest steel-target-only competition, with 250 shooters, two days of competition, 100% steel targets and a prize value exceeding R250 000.

▲ Max Rossle

▲ The now annual event attracted people from all around the province to shoot in every division in practical shooting. Long guns, short guns, optics, iron sight were all well represented.

The appeal of practical shooting

Understanding Metal Mayhem requires understanding why practical shooting continues to attract participants. At its best, practical shooting combines three elements that are individually familiar to firearm enthusiasts but considerably more demanding when combined, namely accuracy, speed and movement.

A competitor cannot simply shoot quickly. Nor can they concentrate exclusively on precision. The aim is to solve the stage efficiently while managing firearm handling, target identification, movement, reloads and accuracy under pressure. That produces a sport in which equipment matters, but equipment alone does not determine performance. For the competitor, that matters because practical shooting is ultimately a problem-solving sport.

The gun is only one component. The competitor must interpret the stage, make decisions, manage movement and maintain accuracy while working against the clock. With steel as the dominant target medium, those decisions acquire an immediate physical consequence.

Speed is important, but uncontrolled speed is expensive. A miss costs more than a fraction of a second. A penalty can erase the advantage of an otherwise blistering run. That tension is the essence of the format. For South African competitors, that combination has obvious appeal. For international readers, it also provides a useful reminder that South Africa has a mature competitive-shooting culture capable of producing events with relevance beyond the domestic market.

▲ Practical shooting offers the pinnacle of balance between accuracy, speed and movement. Add this to the pervasive and pleasing clang of bullets hitting steel and you have Metal Mayhem in its essence.

▲ No excuses for not competing in terms of your weapon type. Metal Mayhem offered the entire course of fire for a range of long and short guns. The above shooter was competing in EDC (Everyday Carry), using a stock pistol and duty type equipment.

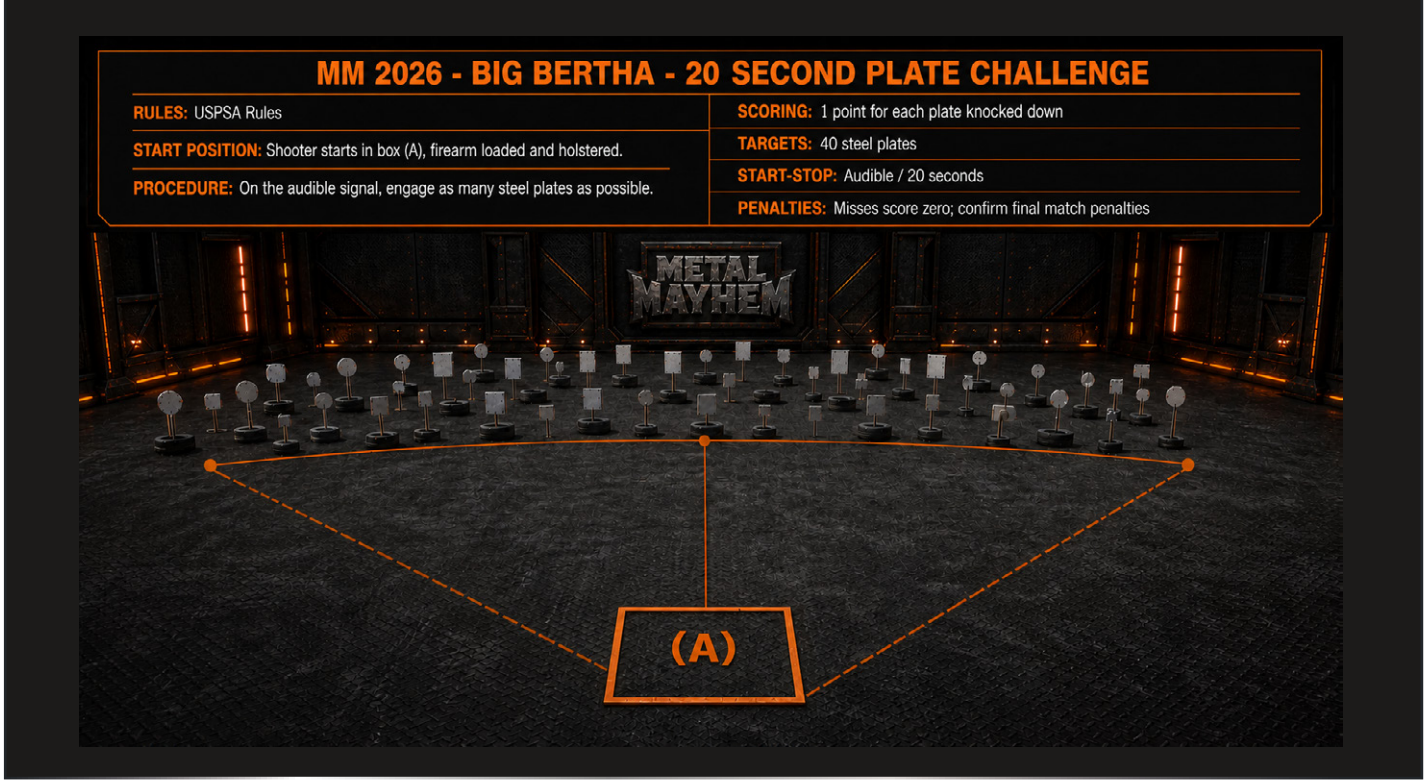
Fourteen divisions and ten steel stages

Metal Mayhem 2026 offered competitors a choice of 14 divisions. Whatever your preferred weapon type, there was an option for all comers.

The 2026 course-of-fire offered ten stages. Courses of fire ranged from the static seven shot, two target weak handed ‘For the Weak’ stage to the 24 round, multiple position ‘Big Bertha’ to the 40 target, shoot as many as you can in 20 seconds ‘All the Steel’. The stages we well designed, challenging and fun, with each differing significantly.

Each stage was supervised by a qualified Range Officer, whereafter scores and times were entered into an online app. Once agreed and signed off by the competitor, assisted by a scorer, Hit Factor Scoring (Shooter Points ÷ by Shooter Time) was applied.

The competitor with the highest hit factor on a specific stage won that stage and earned 100% of the available stage points.



▲ Big Bertha

All other shooters received stage points as a proportional percentage of the winner's hit factor [(Shooter HF ÷ Winner HF) × Available Stage Points]. Match winners were determined by summing the stage points across all stages.

Match organisation and competitor spirit

I must take my hat off to the organisers in terms of the match organisation. Everything ran like clockwork. Each stage was allotted ample time, with a siren signalling when to move onto the next stage. There were no queues or backlogs; only on one stage did we have to wait a noticeable period before moving onto the next.

Camaraderie between shooters was evident, cheers were abundant when a stage was shot well, and one shooter in my squad even brought a ghetto blaster to add music to the festivity. Range safety, of course, was the highest priority.

More than shooting

Perhaps the most unexpected part of the Metal Mayhem proposition is its social-responsibility programme. The Metal Mayhem community donated more than two tons of dog food, cat food and hay in 2025 to animal shelters Shooters are encouraged to bring additional supplies to the event.

This year that amount was surpassed with a total of 2 396 kg of dog and cat food, R8 200 in cash and R10 000 raised for **Childhood Cancer Foundation South Africa (CHOC)**.

Metal Mayhem thanks all sponsors who generously sponsor this annual event. All future sponsorships are welcomed. Make contact now with Billy and Anco to get involved in 2027.

▲ Fun and camaraderie were the underlying themes of Metal Mayhem 2026. Above, 'All the Steel' was a 40 plate, hit as many as you can in 20 seconds stage. As with every stage, organisation was slick and efficient, adding to the very special atmosphere of the event.

▲ Founders of Metal Mayhem, Billy Rosslee (left) and (right) Anco Pretorius, with just some of the donations raised by Metal Mayhem for worthy causes at Magnum United Shooting Range.

For a firearm event, that is more than a nice footnote. It demonstrates an understanding that sports-shooting exists within broader communities and that an event brand can build goodwill through participation in causes unrelated to firearms.

Concluding thoughts

Metal Mayhem is a shoot like no other. From modest beginnings, it has grown and evolved year after year into something quite unique and one of the most anticipated fixtures on the shooting calendar.

For serious top shooters, it is an opportunity to sharpen their skills. For others, it is simply a chance to enjoy a great day of shooting. But for everyone, it is a chance to spend a day of pure, safe, unadulterated fun sharing the sport that you love with like-minded people, while supporting a good cause.

Metal Mayhem is perhaps best understood not as an alternative to South Africa's existing practical-shooting structure, but as an example of how an event can develop its own personality within it.

Part V's inclusion in the 2026 South African competition calendar confirms that the project has become an established part of the country's handgun competition landscape.

The bigger question is where it goes next. If the project continues to build its identity, maintain strong match administration and cultivate the community around the event, Metal Mayhem has the ingredients required to become more than a local match. It could become a South African shooting *brand*. That distinction matters.

The event itself is a substantial competition with international-quality stages. It offers multiple divisions, significant prizes and a strong domestic shooting-industry presence.

Magnum United Shooting Range has plans to grow the event in future, with more divisions and possibly a countrywide co-ordinated event all on the cards. Whichever direction it might go in, it has evolved into South Africa's ultimate spectacle of steel, with the potential to turn a shooting match into a destination event.

▲ Overall champion Hilfred Siebrits at the well-attended prizegiving.

▲ As well as significant prize sponsorship from major shooting industry players, Metal Mayhem offered its own merchandise range to acquire as souvenirs.

Website:
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KINETIC SOLUTIONS

Adrian Burrows of Kinetic Solutions, competitor in the 2026 Metal Mayhem contributed this report.

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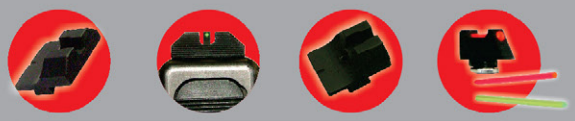

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▲ Adrian Luppnow engaging targets with his CZ 75 SP-01 Shadow fitted with a Trijicon SRO red dot.

EPPSA Handgun Level III Selection Match

By Adrian Luppnow

The Eastern Province Practical Shooting Association (EPPSA) hosted its Handgun Level III selection match at the Port Elizabeth Rifle and Pistol Club (PERPC) from 8 to 11 October. Range Officers, match officials and sponsors competed in the pre-match on Thursday 8 October and Friday 9 October. The match itself consisted of 295 rounds and 17 stages. A total of 339 competitors made up twenty-four squads. This was the first of three handgun selection matches to determine teams to represent South Africa at the IPSC African Handgun Championship (Level IV) to take place in Bulawayo, Zimbabwe in September 2027. This was also the South African Championship 2026 match.

PERPC embarked on a major project last year to relocate all handgun ranges from the valley below to next to the existing rifle range. Bush had to cleared with the required studies and permits in place, before earth moving equipment could break ground on the new site. This match would be the first big match on the new ranges.

Above average rainfall leading up to the match, resulted in extremely muddy conditions. Earth moving equipment had to be brought back onto the ranges to remove the mud, allowing for the construction of stages for the match. High winds over the weekend blew range equipment over, resulting in a few stages having to be rebuilt three times, but the range builders and organisers persevered and got the ranges built in time for vetting and the pre-match.

The ranges were well set out and built with a dedicated maintenance crew on hand to resolve any equipment failure and breakages. Stage design appeared to be simple but proved to be technically challenging with some far targets and steel poppers.

The competitor equipment check took place on Friday 9 October from 16:30 to 18:00. Competitors completed nine stages on Saturday 10 October. The main match began at 08:00 and finished by 17:00. The day started off cool and made for pleasant shooting but turned warmer and breezy later in the day.

Day Two began on Sunday at 08:00 with competitors completing nine stages, including the chrono stage. The day started cool, but became hot and windy, which made for dusty conditions. The timetable showed that shooting would end at 17:00, but many squads were done well before then.

▲ Squad conducting their three-minute stage walk through.

The prizegiving and dinner commenced at 18:30, with winners receiving medals and overall winners for 2026 receiving trophies.

The following stages proved to be the highlights:

Stage 3 was a short course of 12 rounds, with 5 IPSC targets, 1 IPSC popper, 1 IPSC metal plate and 1 IPSC 'no shoot' target. The handgun was loaded and placed on a table with barrel on the demarcated line, pointing down range. This stage was technical and governed by several IPSC rules. Competitors unfamiliar with the rules incurred penalty points or faced disqualification.

The start position of the handgun is stipulated under **IPSC Rule 10.2.8**, which states:
"If a course of fire (or part thereof) stipulates shooting strong or weak hand only, a competitor will incur one procedural penalty for each occurrence of touching the handgun (or scooping it from a table etc.) with the other hand after the Start Signal (or from the point where single hand shooting has been stipulated). Exceptions are releasing an external safety (without scooping), reloading or correcting a malfunction. However, the procedural penalty will be applied on a "per shot fired" basis when a competitor uses the other hand or arm to: 10.2.8.1 support the handgun or the stipulated wrist, hand or arm while firing shots: 10.2.8.2 increase stability on the ground, a barricade or another prop while firing shots."

▲ Open Division competitor engaging targets though an aperture in the barricade

▲ Competitor engaging targets, weak hand unsupported on Stage 3.

▲ Squad 24 being briefed by Range Officers on Stage 1.

▲ Range Officer using overlays to confirm the score for Aidan Jones.

▲ Competitor engaging targets with his Canik SFx Rival-S.

Competitors began anywhere in the demarcated area, standing with both arms hanging naturally by the sides, as per Appendix E2. Upon the start signal, all targets had to be engaged from within the demarcated area weak hand only, unsupported. Several competitors received a procedural penalty for placing their strong side hand on their leg while engaging targets and thus increasing their stability.

According to the IPSC Handgun Competition Rules, Appendix E2 is a diagram of equipment position and shows the foremost limit for gun, holster and allied equipment behind the hip bone at the start signal. The diagram also displays both arms hanging naturally as per Rule 8.2.2.

The difficulty of the stage was engaging targets with your weak hand only and moving from one shooting position to another, while keeping your finger off the trigger and out of the trigger guard. Several competitors received a disqualification for infringement. The IPSC rule covering disqualification – unsafe gun handling applied.

IPSC Rule 10.5.11 states: *"Failure to keep the finger outside the trigger guard during movement in accordance with rule 8.5.1". IPSC rule 8.5.1 states "Except when the competitor is actually aiming or shooting at targets, all movement must be accomplished with the fingers visibly outside the trigger guard and the external safety should be applied. The firearm must be pointed in a safe direction."*

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The demarcated area was rectangular, with the table in the middle. Upon the start signal, the competitor engaged two IPSC targets and one IPSC metal plate, before moving to the left-hand side to engage one IPSC target, partially obscured with hard cover. The competitor then made their way to the right-hand side of the demarcated area to engage one IPSC target, partially obscured by a IPSC 'no shoot' target, before engaging one IPSC target and one IPSC popper through an aperture in a barricade to complete the stage. This was a technically difficult stage.

Stage 7 was a medium stage of 24 rounds, with 9 IPSC targets, 4 IPSC mini poppers, 2 IPSC metal plates and 1 IPSC 'no shoot' target. The handgun was loaded and holstered. Competitors began the stage with both heels touching 'A'. Upon the start signal, the competitor engaged one IPSC target on the left-hand side and one IPSC target partially obscured with hard cover on the right-hand side, before moving down the demarcated area to engage two IPSC targets and two IPSC metal plates. From this shooting position the competitor turned to their right-hand side to engage one IPSC target and one IPSC mini popper in a gap between barricades. These two targets were only visible from this position.

The competitor then made their way to the right-hand side to engage three IPSC targets roughly 15 m down range and one IPSC target partially covered by a 'no shoot' target. The remaining three IPSC mini poppers were roughly 20 m from this position and proved challenging. On the course of fire, the stage looked simple and fast but, in reality, the competitor had to slow down, aim, and ensure scoring shots on the steel. Follow-up shots on a miss wasted precious time.

Stage 9 was a short stage of 9 rounds, with 2 IPSC targets, 2 IPSC mini poppers and 3 IPSC metal plates. The handgun was loaded and holstered. The competitor could start anywhere in the demarcated area, a suspended platform. Upon the start signal, the competitor engaged targets strong hand only, unsupported. IPSC mini popper 2 (IMP2) activated a swinging target with two IPSC metal plates (PL2, PL3) partially obscured by hard cover and disappearing from view.

▲ Kerry Bonnage engaging targets with his CZ Shadow 2 fitted with a Holosun red dot.

▲ Range Officers checking a competitor's match ammunition with a Garmin chronograph.

▲ Arthur Janse van Rensburg standing with both wrists above shoulders on Stage 2.

The difficulty of the stage was engaging the two swinging IPSC metal plates and one IPSC target partially obscured with hard cover at roughly 10 m from the shooting position, while balancing on a suspended platform.

Stage 13 was a short stage of 12 rounds, with 12 IPSC targets and 2 IPSC 'no shoot' targets. The handgun was loaded and holstered. The competitor could start anywhere in the demarcated area with arms hanging naturally by the side.

IPSC Rule 9.5.1 states: *"Unless otherwise specified in the written stage briefing, scoring paper targets must be shot with a minimum of one round each, with the best two hits to score. Scoring metal targets must be shot with a minimum of one round each and must fall to score."*

In this case, the written stage briefing stipulated one scoring hit per target. This was a very different stage and deviated from the norm of two scoring hits per target. Several competitors engaged the targets with two shots, before realising their mistake and engaging the remaining targets with one scoring hit, as required. No penalty was incurred, but it wasted time.

Most began the stage in the bottom left corner of the demarcated area to engage three IPSC targets, before moving to their right-hand side to engage three IPSC targets. The competitor then made their way to the front of the demarcated area to engage three IPSC targets around a barricade, before turning to the right-hand side to engage three IPSC targets to complete the stage. IPSC targets were close on this stage, covered by hard cover and 'no shoot' targets.

▲ Tara Maidwell engaging targets with her Standard Division Handgun on Stage 16.

Stage 17 was a short stage of 12 rounds, with 4 IPSC targets and 4 IPSC metal plates. The handgun was holstered with chamber and magwell empty, with all magazines on the belt. The competitor began the stage with toes of both feet touching 'A' and both wrists above shoulders. Upon the signal, the competitor stepped back and to their right- or left-hand side while loading their handgun, depending mostly on whether they were a right-hand or left-hand shooter. The competitor engaged one IPSC target and one IPSC steel plate from around barricades before moving to the front of the demarcated area to engage the remaining IPSC targets and plates.

The demarcated area was in a 'V' shape. The competitor moved to each corner of the demarcated area to engage all targets obscured with barricades. The competitor had to do a lot of work on this stage. Starting with wrists above shoulders, drawing the handgun and a magazine, loading the magazine into the handgun and loading a round into the chamber, while moving to a shooting position, keeping the trigger finger out of the trigger guard and keeping the handgun pointed in a safe direction.

The second handgun selection match will be hosted at the Excalibur Shooting Range in Welkom, Free State Province from 29 to 31 January 2027.

EPPSA would like to thank the following sponsors for making the match possible:

CZ – Formalito, Bos Ninja, Braemar Paints, Earmor, Eastern Cape Medical Response (ECMR), Gezi, Kazin Rentals, LLL Plant Hire, Mass Hire, Mpact, *On Target Africa*, Pot O' Curry, Premier Protection Services, Rescomp, Sport Shooter SA, Willow Wellness.

Match results can be viewed online at https://portal.ipscess.org/portal/match/6b7952f2-ccd5-4210-8766-b2a0e199afd4

Open Winners
Dylan Henstock
Pieter Burger
Tyrone MacLeod

Production Winners
Leibrandt Swart
Ian van der Bank
Aeron Wecke

Standard Winners
Keith Rolls
Ruan Beneke
Mohammed Fakie

Production Optics Winners
Hilfred Siebrits
Heinke Hartdegen
Dirk van der Walt

Optics Winners
Johan Otto
Grant Chancellor-Maddison
Abrie Preller

Classic Winners
Bryan Robinson
Andre Marais
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THE GOOD, THE BAD AND THE UGLY

By Jason 'Roach' Codd

▲ The Two Posses at the start of the National

In the unlikely event you happened to be driving past Arizona farm outside Bloemfontein between 24 and 26 September, you may have thought yourself caught in some bizarre wormhole transporting across space and time to the Wild West frontier days.

Dirt streets, a tin-roofed saloon, a jail, a pony express office, and even an undertakers may have crossed your vision, along with groups of ladies and gents clad in Stetsons, sombreros and Justin boots and wielding six shooters and lever guns. Perhaps we can help make sense of what you saw.

Whether an early John Wayne movie, Kevin Costner's *Dances with Wolves*, or even Yellowstone and its spinoff(s) *1883* and *1923*, most of us have been exposed to the Western genre. In fact, if you grew up before personal screen devices, you likely played 'Cowboys and Indians' at some point in your childhood. Some of us, it appears, never grew out of that! As the old saying goes, boys never grow up, their toys just get more expensive. Cue Cowboy Action Shooting (CAS), which transcends gender, age and cultural divides. But what is CAS, and where did it all start?

A multi-faceted shooting sport

The formal description, according to the Single Action Shooting Society, is that CAS is "a multi-faceted shooting sport in which contestants compete with firearms typical of those used in the taming of the Old West: single action revolvers, pistol calibre lever action rifles, and old-time shotguns."

LEADERS IN LONG RANGE

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However, the simpler explanation is that we are like a bunch of overgrown kids playing Western dress-up and using old fashioned guns. Think 3-Gun Nation or SADPA Multigun, but with firearms used 150 years ago. With fancy dress!

CAS™ harks back to 1981 when founder Harper Creigh, aka Judge Roy Bean, had a brainstorm. An avid shooter in the then modern type shooting matches, he called on a few friends to shoot their next match with Western type firearms, and it grew from there. There are currently participants throughout all 50 US States, as well as over 20 countries.

▲ Examples of guns used

Origins in South Africa

So, how did it end up in South Africa? Although we have different methods of cattle farming, there are actually some links to the Wild West (look up Texas Jack's Wild West Circus and Will Rogers). CAS commenced in South Africa in 2004 when our Territorial Governor, the official who acts as a link between local clubs and SASS headquarters, began promoting the shooting sport. However, the need to comply with South African firearm licensing requirements led to several changes in the structure and affiliation of the early clubs.

Initially, enthusiasts gathered socially to shoot using cap-and-ball revolvers. The group initially aligned with the Cape Southern Africa Arms and Ammunitions Collectors Association before Western Shooters of South Africa was established as a formal club in Cape Town. The club ultimately affiliated with SASS, the international governing body for CAS. The full story can be found on the Western Shooters of South Africa website.

With the need to grow membership and provide dedicated sports-shooting status in 2010, thanks to lots of hard work by **Damian Enslin**, a name you should be familiar with in the firearm fraternity, WSSA received formal accreditation from CFR as a recognised sporting body.

▲ Lion Mountain Creek Cowboy Town in the Free State

National and international expansion

Other fledgeling clubs became affiliated, and the accreditation led to a restructuring of the local Cape Town club as the Western Territory Rangers, leaving the WSSA to serve as South Africa's governing body for CAS, with a goal of expanding the sport nationally and participating in international competitions. We currently have eight, approaching nine, formally affiliated clubs in South Africa.

Much like other forms of sports-shooting, there is a rulebook, referred to as the Shooter's Handbook. This stipulates the rules and requirements for the sport, the firearms used and the scoring. However, unlike most shooting sports, where the divisions focus on differences in the firearms, CAS divisions also focus on the costuming, the fun aspect of the game.

THE WILDER THE GET-UP THE BETTER.

While t-shirts, sneakers and Lycra (sorry IPSC shooters!) are frowned upon for regular participants, costuming can be as simple as a pair of jeans and a dress shirt, or as extravagant as classic B-Western Hollywood movies such as *Roy Rogers* or *The Three Amigos*. In fact, B-Western is a specific division, and the wilder the get-up the better.

A variety of costuming

Many shooters tend to stick to age-based divisions in South Africa due to the scarcity of flamboyant outfits, but at any match you will still see a variety of costuming. You will also find divisions based on how people shoot their revolvers, rather than what their revolvers are.

Cowboy/Cowgirl tends to shoot in a modern fashion, one gun at a time, with two hands on the gun. Gunfighter allows dual wielded revolvers, typically firing each alternately, with Duellist firing a revolver single handed.

There are also divisions for Black Powder revolvers (Frontier), Classic Cowboy (firearm types and minimum calibre requirements), and juniors under 14 (Buckaroo), who may participate with .22s and .410 shotguns.

▲ Dusty Devil Dual Wielding (Gunfighter)

▲ Murals help draw the Crowds (FBSSC)

▸ Typical stage setup

◂ Props and decorations are also important!

▲ Quincy Cole running his lever gun

◂ Calamity Jane Shows off at Wild Bunch

A UNIQUE ASPECT IS THE USE OF ALIASES ON THE SCORECARD.

CAS is essentially Cowboy 4 Gun, shooting mainly steel targets up close for time and penalties for misses. Targets are usually meant to be shot in specific sequences. Messing that sequence up earns additional time penalties. A unique aspect of the shooting sport is the use of aliases on the scorecard.

Choosing your alias

These may be derived from a characteristic or personality trait, based on a real historical figure, or simply something that sounds cool. You get to choose your own alias at your first match, and it seldom changes from there on. Beware of letting others choose for you! So you will hear calls for, and see scoresheets reflecting, Richmond P. Hobson, Gold Diggin Jacqui, Quincy Cole, El Paso Pete or Walela rather than Peter, Paul or Mary.

Ammunition covenants are strict, with bullets being mainly lead or polymer coated only, an important consideration due to the close steel targets. Power factor requirements are about half of most modern shooting sports, and we have maximum velocity stipulations.

Participants in main matches make use of two revolvers, a rifle and a shotgun, typically with a design prior to 1899. For revolvers, we are talking Clint Eastwood as the Man with No Name rather than Dirty Harry. As the full SASS name implies, these are single-action revolvers, often based on, but not limited to, the Colt Peacemaker of 1873.

Lookalikes versus the real deal

Original Colts are seldom used due to their value, but there are a variety of more modern Colts, Italian reproductions from companies such as Uberti and Pietta, and the Ruger range of lookalikes, but with very different internal workings. Other types such as a Smith and Wesson Model 3, and even lesser-known revolvers, may be used.

Rifles are usually lever-action holding preferably ten rounds and mostly based on Winchester or Marlin designs. Longer barrels may look better, while shorter barrels tend to be more manoeuvrable. Shotguns are mostly side-by-side breakneck guns (without ejectors) and may have internal or external hammers. However, 1887 lever shotguns and 1897 pump action shotguns are also permitted.

Due to the limited availability of these firearms, especially 1897 shotguns, WSSA makes certain allowances to encourage participation, within reason. For example, most pump action shotguns can be used provided they at least have a wood-like look and feel. However, your Magpul Super 3000 would be slightly frowned upon.

The nuances of the correct firearm

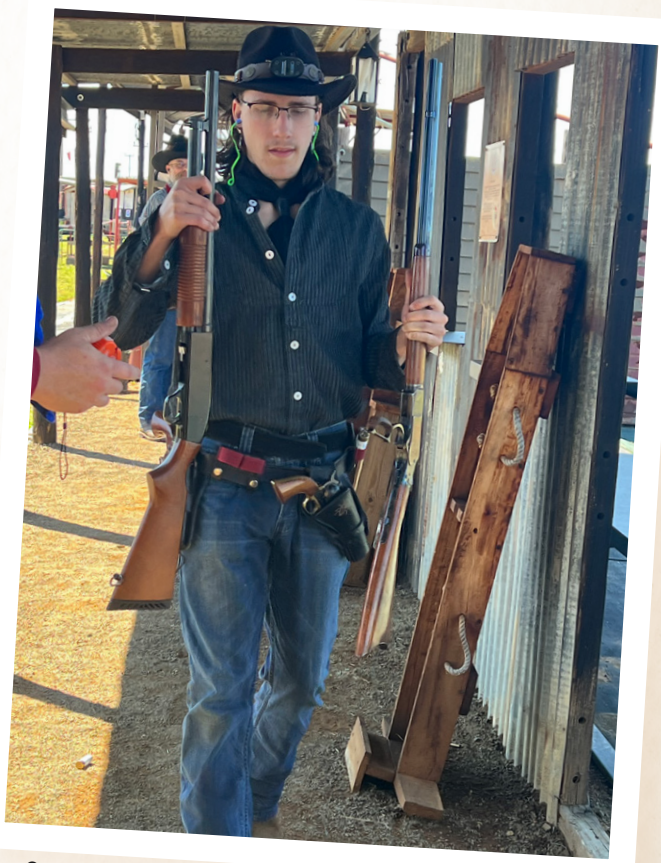
There are a lot more nuances to it, with Wild Bunch matches allowing 1911s, Derringer, Long Range and other side matches using very different firearms, so we always recommend attending a match to see what goes on before committing to any purchases.

So, with all that out under the belt, why would you have seen a busy Wild West town in the middle of the Free State? Here the WSSA National was held at a dedicated cowboy town, Lion Mountain Creek, attended by about 30 shooters from across the country. This represents about 20% to 25% of current active WSSA members.

Lion Mountain Rangers, the Bloemfontein club, have built their home into an accredited range, with dedicated building façades for each range, and then built a town around it, literally with homes (okay, cabins) on the premises.

A three-day National

Over the course of the three days, participants shot eight Cowboy Action stages, four Wild Bunch stages, and side matches for Long Range Lever rifles, Military Bolt Action Rifle, Derringer and Pocket Pistol.



▲ Creed shows it is not just for old timers

▲ Killer Karl models a Magalito Target

Most shooters stayed on-site, meals were served in the cantina, the saloon was hopping in the evenings, and generally great fun was had by all. The winners of the various divisions were as follows:

Match	Gents	Ladies
Cowboy Action Shooting		
Cowboy/Cowgirl	Creed	Walela
Duellist	Dutch Hawken	
Forty Niner	Quincy Cole	Calamity Jane
Gunfighter	Dusty Devil	
Senior	Slixty	Sally Saloon
Silver Senior	Canvas Pete	
Elder Statesman	Mad Dog Ludwig	
Wrangler	Brisco Country kid	
Wild Bunch Action Shooting		
Modern	Canvas Pete	Calamity Jane
Traditional	Texas Devil	
Side Matches		
Military Bolt Action Rifle	Billy44	Sally Saloon
Long Range Lever (Pistol Cal)	Roach	Calamity Jane
Long Range Lever (Rifle Cal)	Psycho Syd	Sally Saloon
Pocket Pistol	ZA Kid	Sally Saloon
Derringer	Creed	Sally Saloon

▲ Maintenance. What's that?

▲ Walela shows us how to dress AND shoot!

Should you wish to see pics and videos from the National, find out more about CAS or clubs in your area, please find us as follows:

Website: **https://westernshooters.co.za/**

Facebook: **https://www.facebook.com/groups/1748953368729083** (Western Shooters of South Africa)

Attend a match, even if just to spectate and talk to the pards! CAS has a rather popular saying: ***Come for the shooting, stay for the people.***

If you are interested in the actual scores, they can be found on PractiScore, searching for 'Western Shooters of South Africa Nationals Sep 2026'

The Swarm Gathers in Bloemfontein

By Annerien Snyman

The National Championship remains the undisputed highlight on the South African National School Shooter Union (SANSSU) calendar. The 2026 event from 26 September to 1 October transformed Bloemfontein in the Free State into a buzzing hive of activity with 434 dedicated shooters, officials and supportive parents from across the country.

School-level sport shooting takes our youth of today from callow bees to bees, the future of our sport in South Africa. These callow's learn discipline, hard work, persistence, fair play, integrity, respectful conduct, graciousness, and ethical behaviour and sportspersonship as part of school-level sport shooting.

However, the moment our competitors step onto the firing line, the lingering school break atmosphere instantly evaporates. The casual holiday spirit gives way to fierce, serious competition as the youth narrow their focus down the 10m lanes.

The Host Province: A Masterclass in Organisation

As always, every host province strives to make the National Championship unforgettable, and the Free State lived up to that proud tradition this year with exceptional organisation and meticulous attention to detail.

From the initial planning stages to the very last pellet fired, dedicated individuals strived to make the event seamless. Parents, shooters, coaches, sponsors, volunteers and the tireless team behind the scenes each formed a crucial piece of the puzzle.

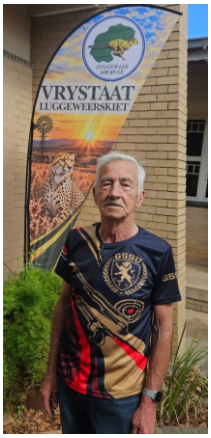
For a few days, Hoërskool Sentraal transformed from a quiet academic workplace into a premier proving ground where young shooters could showcase their talent, discipline, focus and hard work. This year a digital flipbook with all vital shooting information was sent to all attendees.

It was a massive hit, proving exceptionally valuable in making schedules and rules easily accessible throughout.

The atmosphere was further enhanced by wonderful photo opportunities scattered across the venue, featuring special spots adorned with beautiful cheetah signs that made team pictures extra special.

The opening ceremony itself was beautifully executed and incredibly well-attended, so much so that the organisers almost ran out of seating.

Fortunately, the weather turned out in our favour, remaining pleasantly cool and creating perfect outdoor conditions for the gathering. Free State Air Rifle Shooting has undoubtedly made its mark, leaving us eager for next year.



The Psychology of the Smile

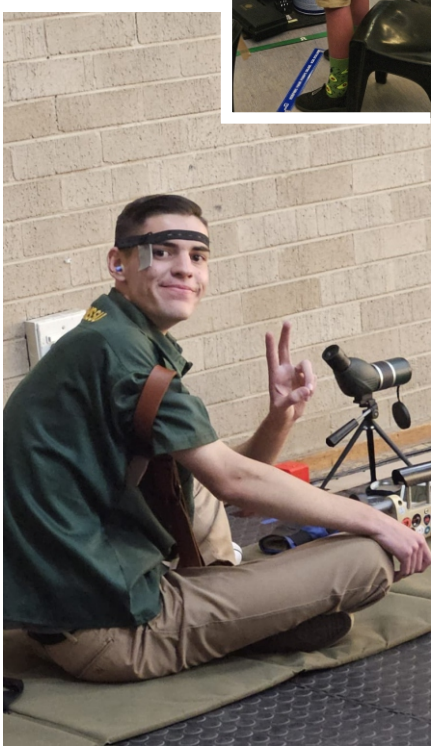
Apart from shooting, what do our youth athletes do best? They SMILE. In the demanding world of target shooting, a competitor's outward expression is usually a masterclass in controlled composure.

Underneath that intense, unyielding focus, however, a genuine smile tells a fascinating story about the psychology, physiology and sheer joy of the sport.

Coaches frequently emphasise the importance of maintaining a relaxed, positive demeanour, especially when navigating a difficult string of shots. A quick, knowing smile, sometimes directed at oneself after a stray shot, is a vital mental reset. Smiling actively breaks the destructive cycle of frustration, lowers elevated heart rates, and prevents those detrimental micro-tensions from creeping into the shoulders and neck before the next trigger pull.

The science behind this is fascinating in that a smile triggers a physical release of dopamine while causing a sudden drop in adrenaline. Finding that micro-moment of perfection provides a deeply satisfying sense of harmony between the shooter's body and their equipment.

Of course, the most obvious time a shooter smiles is after the final scores are tallied, particularly when they shatter a personal best (PB) or proudly stand on the podium. A podium smile reflects pure relief, the sweet validation of months of gruelling dry-firing, and immense gratitude for the support system of coaches, parents and teammates standing steadfastly behind the line. As the saying goes on the range: Some people are wise, some are … otherwise.



The Sweet Taste of Success: Results & Records

To all the medal winners, all those quiet hours of hard work, determination, and rock-solid focus on the shooting range finally paid off. Given the incredibly high standard of shooting at this level, this is no small achievement. You make the SANSSU community and the entire country immensely proud.

Gunter Jonker

Matthew Schutte

Mea Coetzer

The results margin was razor-thin, featuring five count-outs for positions and an impressive 25 full-score target cards. The pinnacle of accuracy was showcased with one spectacular two double full-scores (400 out of 400).

Massive congratulations are in order for the standout performers: Matthew Schutte, Annabelle Kirstein, Jacobus J. Badenhorst, Megan Myburgh, Zander Stoltz, Stephni Laubscher, Simoné Oosthuizen, Monique Steyn, Etienne van der Merwe, Jan Hendrik van Loggerenberg, Antoné Du Plessis, Megan-Lee Schutte, Marius Beneke, Austin Smit, Divan Koekemoer, Brian Wasserman and Gino Fogolin.

History was also rewritten, with two SANSSU records broken and one record equalled. In the Precision discipline, Gunter Jonker broke the 10m record and successfully set a new baseline record for the overall score. Meanwhile, in the Springer U16 10m category, William Long demonstrated exceptional skill by equalling the existing record.

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The Worker Bees Turn to Gold: Colours and Champions

The ultimate reward for a youth shooter's dedication is national recognition. This year, an outstanding twenty-nine shooters achieved their SANSSU colours.
Precision: Gunter Jonker, Matthew Schutte, Zelda Grove.

Springer: William Long, Zanru Broodryk, Cheria Du Toit, Johan Serfontein.
Pistol: Marc Schutte, Juwandre van der Sandt, Ané Gerber, Gino Fogolin, Chantal van der Bank.

Sporter: Stephni Laubscher, Anru Robinson, Ruben Schoeman, Mia van der Walt, Karla Penderis, Nash Olivier, Henning Wagenaar, Zeldi van den Berg, Klara Arnoldi, Simoné Oosthuizen, Kara van der Merwe, Stephan Botha, Francois Robertson, Sarah Ferrier, Stefan Keller, Gary Marx, Anje Blom.

Gary Marx and his proud mom

William Long

Pistol Champion
Marc Schutte

Precision Champion
Matthew Schutte

Gunter Jonker

Pistol Champions

Springer Shooters: Gold: Johan Serfontein,
Silver: Stiaan Kock, Henrico du Toit

Sporter Champions: Lara van der Merwe, Simone Oosthuizen, Nash Olivier

The podiums for the Great Champion Shooters saw fierce competition:
Pistol: 1st Marc Schutte,
2nd Mark-Louis Fourie,
3rd Juwandre Van Der Sandt

Springer: 1st Johan Serfontein,
2nd Stiaan Koch, 3rd Henco Du Toit

Precision: 1st Matthew Schutte, 2nd Gunter Jonker, 3rd Zelda Grove

Sporter: 1st Simoné Oosthuizen, 2nd Kara van der Merwe, 3rd Nash Olivier

In the team events, provincial pride was on full display. Gauteng Schools Shooting Union (GSSU) won the provincial title for Pistol (Chantal van der Bank, San-Marie van der Merwe, Simoné van der Merwe, Gino Fogolin, Runel Muller and Alicia Foster).

Ekurhuleni School Shooting Union (ESSU) claimed the Springer title (William Long, Stiaan Koch, Roeleen Lessing, Andre Visagie, Zayne Blomerus, Jean Le Roux, Wian C Coetser and Ziaan Bekker).

Finally, the host province, Free State, affectionately known as the 'Vrystaat se Pronkperde', secured the Sporter title (Mia van der Walt, Kara van der Merwe, Anje Blom, Gary Marx, Henning Wagenaar, Nellie Geldenhuys, Frieda-Marie Labuscagne and JD Kearney).

ESSUn Springer Team

Navigating the Pressure

What were the vibes on the floor? The phrase National Championship inherently means pressure, except perhaps for the less serious shooters. For youth participating in a national championship for the first time, the scale of the event can be deeply frightening. As one parent reflected: “When Mia was much younger, it was overwhelming for her, but I can honestly say she has grown into it.”

The mental hurdles begin long before the first shot is fired. According to Jason, “The scariest times are the equipment and clothing inspections.” Ensuring every button, blinder and rifle dimension meets strict regulations is a heavy psychological weight for a young athlete.

Once on the line, the physical toll of adrenaline is undeniable. During the rapid pistol event, competitors must concentrate so intensely that the fear of disqualification can cause severe stress and anxiety. This often manifests in pounding heartbeats, shaking hands, perspiration and sometimes even tears.

Adding to the mental load is the ever-present dread of a weapon malfunction during the match. Yet, despite the pressure, the youth consistently pushed through. As Carike Delport noted,
“For coaches and provincial management, it is a good thing to see that there is so much interest at the development level, and it means that our sport is growing.”

This great event would not have been possible without the support of these sponsors:

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Expanding the Colony: The Scope of the Championship

The sheer scope of the National Championship is immense. This year, the honeycomb of lanes accommodated 88 Pistol, 9 Precision, 283 Sporter, and 54 Springer competitors, all shooting shoulder to shoulder.

A major highlight of this year's event was the first-time participation of the Alternative Springer Shooters, aged 11 to 13, as well as the under-12 Alternative Sporter Shooters. They competed in a smaller, dedicated competition serving as a trial for full inclusion in future.

This initiative is a vital stepping stone for the youth. The noticeable surge of interest at the development level is a highly encouraging milestone for coaches and provincial management, beautifully underscoring the ongoing expansion of the sport.

By introducing these athletes to the sport early, junior shooters are afforded a tangible glimpse into their own futures. They achieve competitive readiness well in advance of their high school years, giving them a distinct advantage.

Walking the same range as the champions, they witness firsthand that shooting is a highly respected national sport, and that hard work, dedication and perseverance can ultimately lead to prestigious SANSSU colours. The vibrant energy of these youngsters and the active involvement of their families absolutely guarantee the event's successful return next year.

11 Year old Arabella Marais shooting u/14

Mementos, Milestones and the Road Ahead

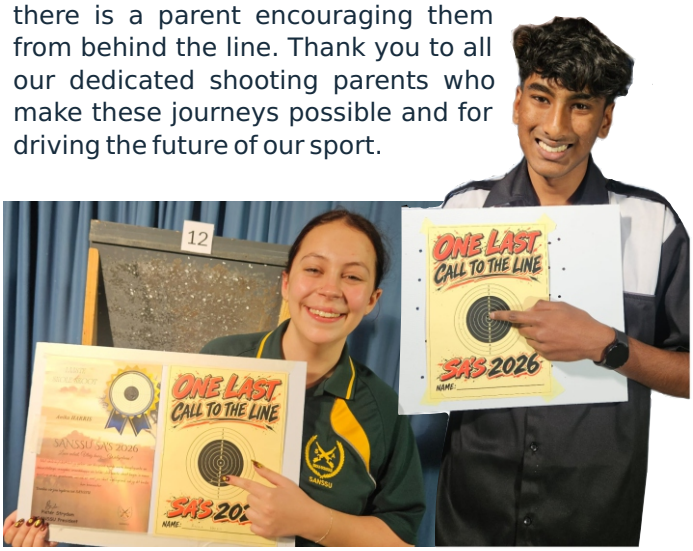
The culture of a championship extends beyond the firing line, heavily relying on the emotional connection of the participants. This was evident in the high sales of event-specific soft toys dressed in national t-shirts, which transcend standard merchandise by connecting directly with what participants and families experience at a major tournament.

Parents and shooters buy these 'cuddles' as a physical anchor for a milestone achievement, celebrating national pride and serving as a "I Was There!" memento. Furthermore, in a high-focus sport requiring immense mental discipline, these soft toys offer warm, emotional comfort and stress relief between relays, celebrating the shared journey of the family.

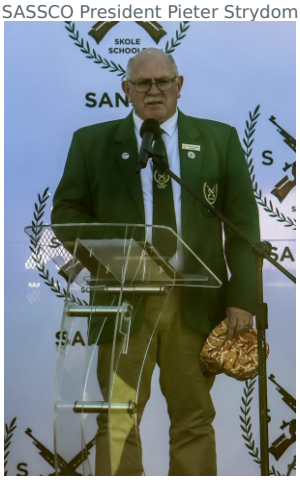
Looking ahead, a major highlight was the supportive presence of SASSCO's leadership. President Bennie van den Heever and Vice President Pannetjies Rossouw attended the opening on Sunday, with Bennie maintaining a continuous presence throughout the week.

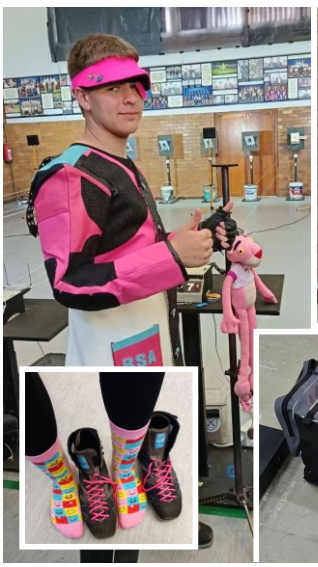
Excellent agreements were concluded between the presidents of SASSCO and SANSSU, with the final dinner and prizegiving proudly attended by Bennie and Corena de Beer. In an incredible boost for youth retention, SASSCO offered every matric shooter an exemption from membership fees for one year after leaving school, provided they join a shooting organisation under SASSCO.

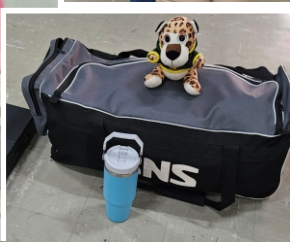
Every champion starts somewhere: a junior competitor squeezing off that first shot, stepping up to the firing point for their opening match, and knowing there is a parent encouraging them from behind the line. Thank you to all our dedicated shooting parents who make these journeys possible and for driving the future of our sport.



SASSCO President Pieter Strydom







This article was complied in association with:

SANSSU

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CTHRSA
CAPE TOWN HUNTING RIFLE SHOOTING ASSOCIATION
HRSA / JSV

HERITAGE DAY VELDSKIET CLINIC & MINI COMPETITION

24 SEPTEMBER 2026

THE RANGE AT PHESANTEKRAAL
Cape Town, Western cape

RIMFIRE and PCP

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▸ Hein de Swardt

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Swarovski Optik AT Endura 21–65x75

Premium HD spotting performance in a rugged, lightweight package

For hunters and shooters who spend long periods behind their optics, a spotting scope needs to do more than simply magnify the view. It needs to deliver a clear, stable image in changing conditions while remaining practical enough to carry and use throughout the day.

The new AT Endura 21–65x75 from SWAROVSKI OPTIK is designed with exactly this in mind, combining HD optical performance with a rugged construction intended for demanding outdoor use.

The scope's 21–65x zoom range allows the user to move quickly from a wider field of view to higher magnification when more detail is required. This is particularly useful when initially locating a subject before increasing magnification to assess it more closely.

Clear detail when conditions get difficult

The AT Endura uses SWAROVSKI OPTIK's HD optical technology to provide high image sharpness, strong contrast and natural colour reproduction. These characteristics are particularly valuable when assessing subjects at longer distances, where fine details can otherwise become difficult to distinguish.

The optical performance is intended to remain useful in less-than-ideal conditions, including low light, shadowed areas, heat shimmer and air turbulence. The result is a stable, usable image that helps the observer distinguish contours and details rather than relying on assumptions. Swarovski Endura

For hunters, this means being able to assess game more effectively in changing terrain and light. The same characteristics are useful for wildlife observation and other applications where accurate long-distance observation is required.

Built for the field

Outdoor optics inevitably have to cope with more than perfect weather. Wind, moisture, temperature changes and extended periods of use are all part of field conditions. The AT Endura has been designed with a deliberately straightforward construction intended to provide reliable performance without unnecessary complexity.

At 1 510 g (53.3 oz), it is also relatively light for a 75 mm spotting scope. This makes a difference when equipment must be carried over distance or used for extended observation sessions. The reduced weight can help limit fatigue while keeping the scope readily available when needed.

HD optical quality

The AT Endura's HD optics are designed to provide three key benefits: rapid subject acquisition through a clear, high-contrast image, comfortable observation and natural colour reproduction. In practical terms, the emphasis is on seeing detail clearly without making the viewing experience unnecessarily complicated.

SWAROVSKI OPTIK positions the AT Endura as an accessible entry point into its premium optics range, while providing performance intended to remain useful as the user's experience and requirements develop.

Capture what you see

For shooters and hunters who want to record observations in the field, the AT Endura can be paired with SWAROVSKI OPTIK's VPA 2 variable phone adapter. The adapter allows a smartphone to be connected to compatible SWAROVSKI OPTIK binoculars or spotting scopes, making it possible to photograph or record what is being viewed through the optic.

The VPA 2 weighs 104 g (3.7 oz) and is designed for straightforward handling, stability and precise positioning of the smartphone camera. It requires the appropriate clamp adapter for the specific binocular or spotting scope.

Also available for the AT Endura is the SOC stay-on case, designed specifically for the spotting scope. It provides a close fit while allowing unrestricted operation of the zoom and focusing rings, combining protection with continued access to the scope's controls.

The SWAROVSKI OPTIK AT Endura 21–65x75 will be available in stores and online from November 2026 through Whylo Distributors.

Contact: www.whylo.co.za

Rigby opens the doors to its new London home

John Rigby & Co. has completed its move to 42 Clapham Manor Street, establishing a new London headquarters designed to bring visitors closer to the craft and history behind its guns.

The Grade II-listed former ballet school has been transformed over three and a half years into a new home for the gunmaker, which celebrated its 250th anniversary in 2025.

The ground floor is dedicated to Rigby's gunmakers, with specialist workshops arranged so that visitors can follow the making of a gun through woodworking, metalworking and finishing. The building also houses the Rigby Academy, an engraving studio, a museum and a showroom.

Historic collection on display

In the showroom, vaulted ceilings and exposed oak beams frame a display of Rigby's guns and historic collection. At its centre is Jim Corbett's rifle, displayed beneath the glass-topped table on which new guns will be presented to clients. It is a tangible connection between the rifles that shaped Rigby's reputation and those being made in London today.

The move gives the company room to grow after more than a decade at Pensbury Place, where Rigby established its workshop following its return to London. The new premises have been planned around the needs of its gunmakers, with space for their work to be seen and understood by visitors.

The next chapter

"Pensbury Place gave us the home we needed to rebuild Rigby, and it will always mean a great deal to us. At Clapham Manor Street, we have been able to create the truly extraordinary home we imagined for the next chapter of the company," comments Rigby Managing Director **Marc Newton**.

"I wanted the gunmakers to be at the heart of it. Visitors will be able to see the skill and care that goes into our guns, then step into a showroom filled with the stories that brought us here. Having Jim Corbett's rifle at the centre of that room, with every new gun presented above it, says a great deal about what our history and craftsmanship mean to us," adds Marc.

Over 250 years' of gunmaking experience

Established in Dublin in 1775, the company has more than 250 years' of gunmaking experience. Rigby opened its first London shop in 1865 and continued operating out of both offices until they closed their Dublin shop in 1897.

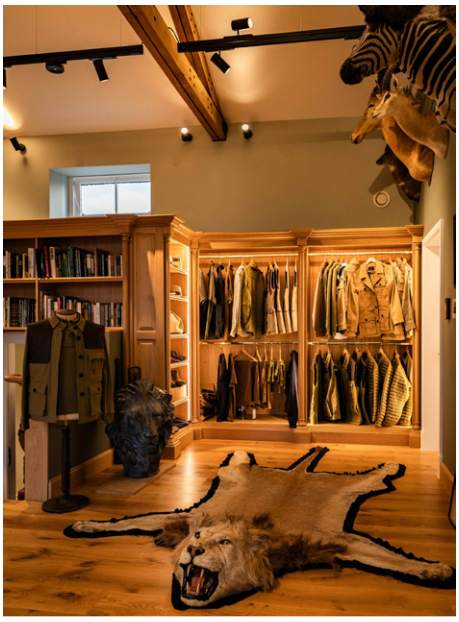
The company moved to the USA in 1997 but returned to London in 2013 when it was bought by L&O Group, Germany. In 2013, Rigby recommenced their historic partnership with Mauser, which dates back to the late 19th century.

It manufactures bolt-action, double rifles and shotguns. Products of particular note include the iconic Rising Bite double rifles and shotguns, fully bespoke London Bests, the award-winning range of Big Game bolt-action rifles and the Highland Stalker.

For more information, visit: **www.johnrigbyandco.com.**

Safari Outdoor, South Africa, is the exclusive retailer for John Rigby & Co.

SAFARI OUTDOOR



Leofoto Juggernaut S2 and S3 tripods

Built for shooters who demand maximum rigidity, stability and rapid deployment

Leofoto's Juggernaut S2 and S3 tripods are designed for shooters who need a robust, stable platform in demanding conditions. With upgraded 45 mm leg tubes, a redesigned apex and heavy-duty components, the new models build on Leofoto's established tripod technology to deliver greater rigidity and versatile deployment options.

Bigger legs, greater stability

The Juggernaut range increases the maximum leg tube diameter from the previous 40 mm to 45 mm. This larger diameter is central to improving rigidity and load capacity, providing a solid foundation for precision shooting. Both models extend to a maximum height of 169 cm, accommodating users up to 1.95 m tall.

Two rapid-deployment designs

The S2 and S3 offer two configurations to suit different requirements. The S2 uses a conventional two-section leg design, prioritising maximum rigidity and rapid deployment. The S3 features a three-section inverted leg design, offering a more compact and portable setup. Both models incorporate oversized, heavy-duty leg joints from Leofoto's Mountain Series. These lock and unlock with just a quarter-turn, making adjustments quick and straightforward.

A redesigned apex

The Juggernaut's redesigned apex introduces several practical improvements. Its compact, modular construction accommodates tripod heads with a 3/8-inch connection, as well as a modular centre column supplied with the tripod. The quick-swap release button works in conjunction with a lever safety lock, allowing components to be changed efficiently.

The first leg-angle position has been increased to 24°, improving stability and lowering the centre of gravity. A pull-down mechanism locks the primary leg angle to help prevent slippage when the tripod is moved rapidly or meets the ground or an obstacle such as a barricade.

This is complemented by a self-returning hinge-lock mechanism designed for single-handed operation. Multiple 1/4" and 3/8" connection points on the apex provide additional mounting options for accessories.

Designed for demanding use

Practical details further enhance the Juggernaut's functionality. On the S2, height markings on the lowest leg section make it easier to set and level the tripod at a specific height without fully extending the legs.

One leg on each model features a neoprene sleeve to improve handling and protect the tripod during heavy use. Both models also include heavy-duty 5-inch XL foot spikes and an HK-03 weight hook.

The Juggernaut Anvil head

The new MA-40SXO Juggernaut Anvil head builds on the MA-30L, increasing the head's size from 30 mm to 40 mm to improve load capacity. Its Arca and Picatinny clamps feature independent gauge adjustment, allowing users to switch between the two mounting systems without repeatedly changing the gauge. Knurled adjustment knobs eliminate the need to carry tools for these adjustments. The head has a maximum load capacity of 54 kg (120 lb).

S2 or S3?

Choose the S2 for maximum rigidity and faster deployment with its two-section legs. The S3 is the option for shooters who prefer a more compact, portable configuration with three-section inverted legs.

Whether competing in Precision Rifle Shooting (PRS) events, hunting in the veld or seeking an exceptionally stable shooting platform, the Leofoto Juggernaut range offers two configurations designed to meet demanding shooting requirements.

Pre-orders now open

Initial supplies of the Juggernaut tripods will be limited due to high demand in the United States. Leofoto South Africa expects small initial shipments, followed by further limited deliveries later in the year. The first large shipment is scheduled to arrive in March 2027.

Stock will be allocated on a first-come, first-served basis. A deposit of R5 000 is required to secure a place on the waiting list.

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Follow Leofoto South Africa on Facebook and YouTube for product demonstrations, shooting setups, practical tips and customer features.

VEXIS™ Night Guard Brings Palm Vein Security To Firearm Storage

Biometric technology offers fast, touch-free access without codes, fingerprints or facial recognition

Securing a firearm safe is about more than keeping unauthorised users out. It is also about ensuring that authorised users can access their firearms conveniently and reliably when required. VEXIS™ Night Guard introduces a new approach to biometric access control, using the unique vein patterns beneath the palm to verify identity.

The next-generation, patent-pending technology combines near-infrared imaging with advanced deep-learning algorithms to capture millions of unique venous data points beneath the skin. These are used to create an encrypted biometric identity for verification.

Your palm is the key

Unlike conventional access methods that rely on codes or surface biometrics, VEXIS™ reads the vein patterns beneath the skin. These internal patterns are unique to everyone and cannot simply be photographed or lifted from a surface in the way fingerprints can.

Access is designed to be straightforward. The user holds their palm near the sensor and, in less than half a second, the system verifies their identity and unlocks the safe. There are no codes to remember and no buttons to press, making the process both quick and convenient.

Speed without compromising privacy

VEXIS™ combines rapid access with an emphasis on biometric data privacy. According to the manufacturer, access data is stored locally within the safe and is not shared, uploaded or connected to external systems.

Since the system reads internal vein patterns rather than surface features, it is also designed to avoid some of the limitations associated with fingerprint recognition. Fingerprints can be affected by dirt, dry skin and wear, while palm vein patterns remain stable throughout adulthood. The technology is also not dependent on external lighting conditions in the way that some optical recognition systems are.

How the technology works

VEXIS™ uses near-infrared light to read the vein patterns beneath the skin. Advanced algorithms then analyse the captured data and verify the user's identity against the stored biometric information.

The scanning process is non-invasive and uses harmless near-infrared light. It does not require physical contact with the sensor, making access both convenient and hygienic. The combination of internal biometric identification, rapid verification and local data storage is intended to provide a further layer of security for firearm storage.

Coming soon

VEXIS™ Night Guard brings palm vein recognition technology to the firearm security market, offering an alternative to traditional code-based access and other biometric systems. The product is coming soon to your nearest Stonewolf Supply Co. nationwide stockist. Be the key to your security.

For more information, contact Stonewolf Supply Co. at **www.stonewolf.co**

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Spuhr SICS: A Chassis That Fits The Shooter

Adjustable ergonomics and a modular platform for precision rifle competition.

Precision rifle shooting demands more than a capable barrel and quality ammunition. The connection between shooter and rifle matters, particularly when moving between prone, seated and supported positions. The Spuhr Ideal Chassis System (SICS) puts that relationship at the centre of its design.

Available through Ultranexus, the Spuhr Chassis R700 LCP SA, Black, 16″ is optimised for compatible Remington 700 short-action clones. Its aluminium construction provides rigid support for the barrelled action, while its adjustable ergonomics help shooters establish a comfortable, repeatable position behind the optic.

Tool-free adjustment

A standout feature is the tool-free adjustment of length of pull and recoil-pad height. With 50 mm of length adjustment and 32 mm of pad-height adjustment, shooters can adapt the stock to different positions. The cheekpiece adjusts in height and length, while the pistol grip offers adjustment to refine trigger reach.

The 16″ forend incorporates an ARCA Swiss rail, providing a convenient interface for compatible shooting supports. A built-in barricade stop adds practicality for positional shooting, and the chassis accepts AICS-pattern magazines, excluding AI AX magazines.

More compact for transport

Its folding stock makes the rifle more compact for transport while providing adjustable lockup when extended. Compatibility should be checked for the intended action, particularly with 60° bolt designs that may restrict folding over a closed bolt.

Ultranexus also brings in SICS interior and exterior weight kits, allowing shooters to tailor rifle balance, plus the CA006FDE Adjustable Bag Rider and 18 mm recoil-pad spacer for further personalisation.

For the sports-shooter building a dedicated precision rifle, the SICS offers a platform that can be configured around individual fit, support equipment and competition requirements. Available in South Africa through Ultranexus and its dealer network. Ask your dealer about chassis compatibility, accessories, pricing and availability.

SPUHR®

Imported and distributed in South Africa by Ultranexus, and available from leading retailers.

ULTRANEXUS

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Spuhr QD Series Mounting System

▲ Cantilever Mount Back View

▲ Cantilever Mount Front View

▲ Cantilever Mount Side View

QDP-3046 Cantilever Mount

A quality riflescope deserves a mounting system that receives just as much attention as the optic itself. For sports shooters who want the flexibility to remove their scope and mount together, Spuhr's quick-detach range offers a practical solution.

The QDP-3046 Cantilever Mount and QDP-4602 Quick-Detach Mount, available in South Africa through Ultranexus, address two different rifle configurations. Both feature a side clamp with dual quick-release levers, allowing the complete scope-and-mount assembly to be detached without opening the scope rings.

Designed for 30 mm scope tubes

The QDP-3046 is designed for 30 mm scope tubes, with a 34 mm mounting height and zero built-in inclination. Its cantilever layout positions the optic 40 mm further forward, making it particularly relevant to compatible AR-style sporting rifles where scope placement and eye relief need careful consideration.

For shooters running 34 mm optics, the QDP-4602 provides a 38 mm mounting height and 6 MIL, about 20.6 MOA, of built-in inclination. With a suitable scope and rifle configuration, this inclination can help preserve elevation adjustment for longer-distance shooting.

Quick detachment benefits

The value of quick detachment extends beyond changing optics. Removing the assembly can simplify transport, storage and access for maintenance while keeping the scope secured in its rings. Adjustable clamping tension allows the mount to be matched to the rail.

As with any precision setup, selecting the correct tube diameter, height and rail configuration matters. Shooters should also confirm zero after refitting an optic before relying on it in competition.

For competitors who appreciate adaptable equipment, these Spuhr QDP mounts offer a purposeful combination of convenient removal and clearly defined mounting options. Available in South Africa through Ultranexus and its dealer network. Ask your dealer about chassis compatibility, accessories, pricing and availability.

QDP-4602 Quick-Detach Mount

▲ Quick-Detach Mount Back View

▲ Quick-Detach Mount Front View

▲ Quick-Detach Mount Side View

SPUHR®

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